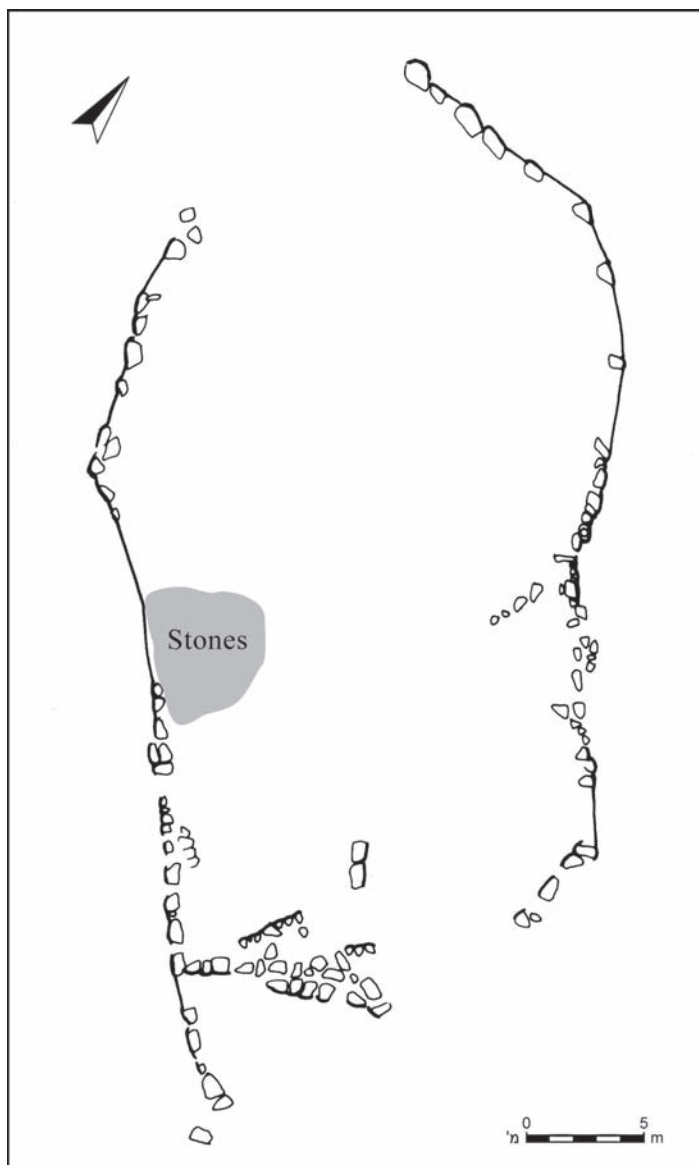


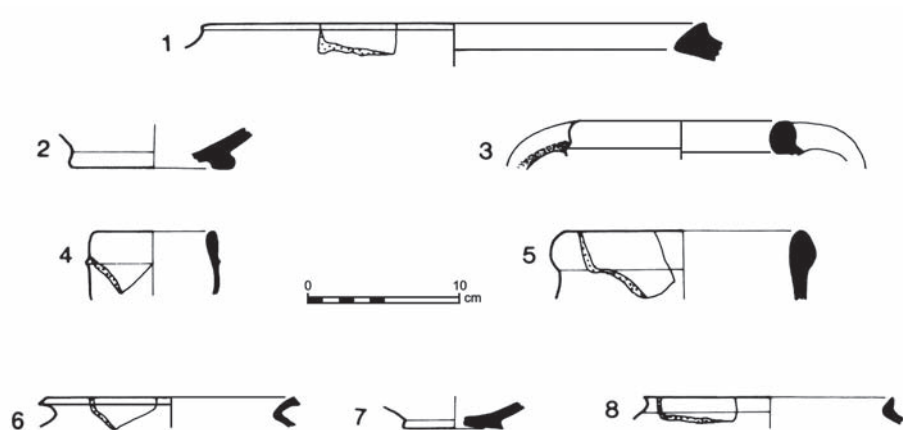
The enclosure is filled with sediments, being now a terrace wall. In the southern part of the enclosure there are small cairns and structural remains.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 5%; IrA IA – 40%; IrA II – 30%; ER – 10%; LR – 15%.

Previous surveys: none.



306. Plan of the enclosure at Khallet Makhul.



307. Pottery from Khallet Makhul: 1. CP, br, MBA II; 2. Jug base, lt br, IrA I; 3. Jar, IrA I; 4. Jar, lt, LR; 5. Pythos, dk br, IrA I; 6. CP, dk, IrA I; 7. Bowl, IrA I; 8. CP Type A, IrA IA.



308. The Iron Age enclosure at Khallet Makhul, looking southwest.
In the background – the hill of Twel edh-Dhyab.

Site 139: 19 – 18/74/2

Khirbet es-Sun'ah

Israel grid: 1977 1844

UTM grid: 7359 5715

Elevation: 70 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 3

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 7 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu
(C23), 2.5 km distant

Visibility: 2

Mar. 2, 1990; 65 shards

A site east of Ro'i, in a small valley in northeastern Buqe'ah. Adjacent to it, in the east, are small ravines, old bunkers and army trenches.

The main component of the site is a rectangular structure, 6x15 m

in size, with a hall (south) and a room (north). The walls, built of very large boulders, are 0.8 m wide. West and north of this structure are three large, hewn, plastered cisterns. Two of them relate to irregular courtyards or enclosures, with



309. The central structure at Kh. es-Sun'ah, looking east. The figure at left stands on one of the threshing floors. In the background are the Mufyeh Hills.

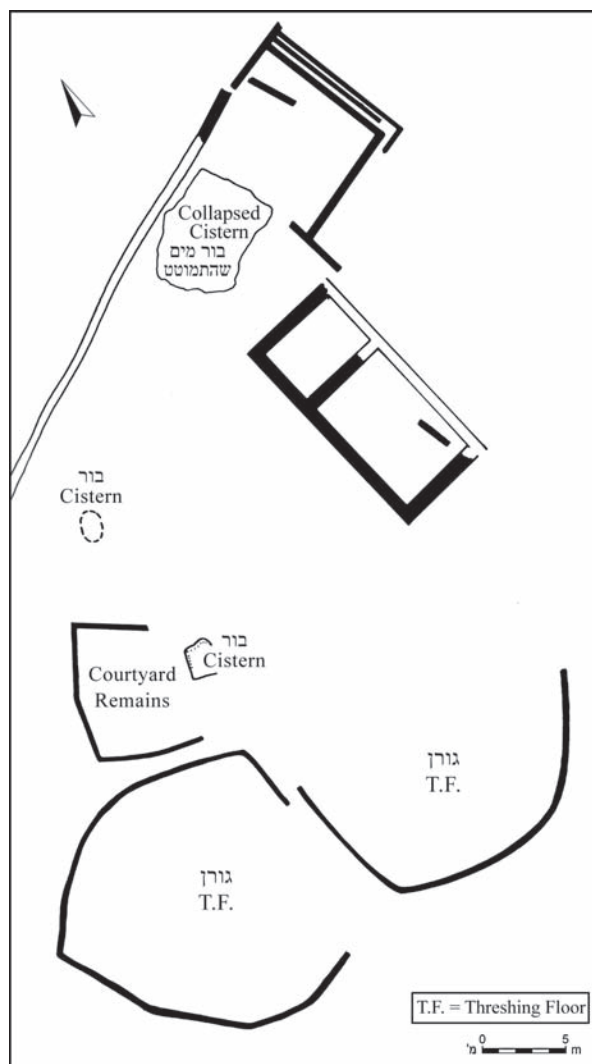
inner cemented surfaces descending to the cistern. The northern cistern, collapsed now, is enclosed with three thin, parallel walls. There are also threshing floors. The northern part of the site is enclosed by a wide wall, of which only sections have survived.

This site is unusual in its con-

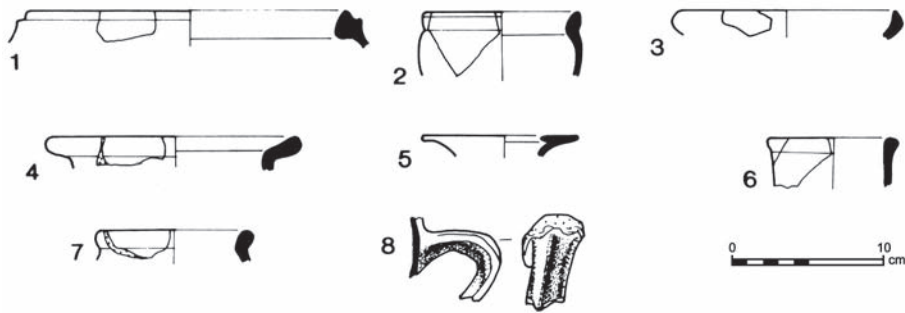
centration of cisterns and threshing floors; possibly it served as a regional center for processing of the summer crops.

Pottery: IrA II – 25%; ER – 2%; LR – 3%; Byz – 30%; EM – 20%; MA – 20%.

Previous surveys: none.



310. Plan of the complex at Kh. es-Sun'ah. Note the threshing floors and cisterns.



311. Pottery from Kh. es-Sun'ah: nos. 1, 3 – IrA II: 1. CP, br; 2. Jar, lt, LR; 3. Bowl, yel; 4. Jar, lt br, ER; 5. Jug, lt, ER; 6, 7. Jar rims, Byz; 8. Handle, Byz.



Site 140: 19 – 18/23/1

Khirbet Muqeysimeh (on the SWP map: Kh. Umm Keis-meh; Guérin: Kh. Oumm Keismah)

Israel grid: 1928 1837

UTM grid: 7321 5701

Elevation: 85 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: large site

Area: 10 dunams (2.5 acres)

Topography: low hilltop in valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 8

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 2.5 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), passes by site

Visibility: 4

Mar. 17, 1988; 50 shards

A large, partially ruined site, on a low hilltop west of Moshav Beqa'ot. To its west runs the road from Wadi el-Far'ah to Meholah. There is a fine view to the center of the Buqei'ah.

The site was surveyed in 1967 by Damti, who describes it as follows: "In the center of the ruin a large structure is discernible; its dimensions are 30x30 m and its wide walls are built of stones in second-

ary use. The main opening is in the western wall; in the northwestern corner remnants of a round wall were located. To the south of the structure is a fallen stone pillar, 3 m in length. To the east and west of the structure were found two small, square towers, around which Iron Age II shards were collected. Hewn stones with Crusader edge hewing (!) were found, as well as cisterns. Possibly the settlement protected

the road between the Jordan Valley and Tubas and Jenin (!)."

In April–May 1972 a salvage excavation was carried out here. Five areas were opened along the above mentioned asphalt road. Dwelling places, containing several rooms, were exposed, with doorposts, hallways and courtyards with ovens. The finds included one coin, a lamp and many shards from the Byzantine Period.

On the ridge slope northwest of the settlement were found ten graves, hewn in the rock. All of them were found looted, with Byz-

antine Period shards nearby. In the burial caves *sarcophagoi* and niches are hewn in the rock. The openings of the burial caves are hewn as arches. This area seems to serve as the site's cemetery.

Pottery: IrA II – 10%; Byz – 30%; EM – 30%; MA – 20%; Ott – 10%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no 149. They mention in particular the cemetery and hewn graves.

Bibliography: SWP II, 241; Guérin 1969 (IV), 254-255; Ilan 1973, 334-335; AN 43 (1973), 11-12.



Site 141: 19 – 18/63/1

Khirbet Umm Butmeh

(on the SWP map: Kh. Umm Butma)

Israel grid: 1968 1832

UTM grid: 7350 5701

Elevation: 38 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: structure

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 7 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Argaman (C21), passes by site

Visibility: 3

May 19, 1982; Apr. 14, 1990; 27 shards

* * *

A structure in the northern edge of the central Buqe'ah, about 1 km southeast of Moshav Ro'i. A dirt road nearby leads to the eastern Buqe'ah.

The structure, about 8x10 in size,

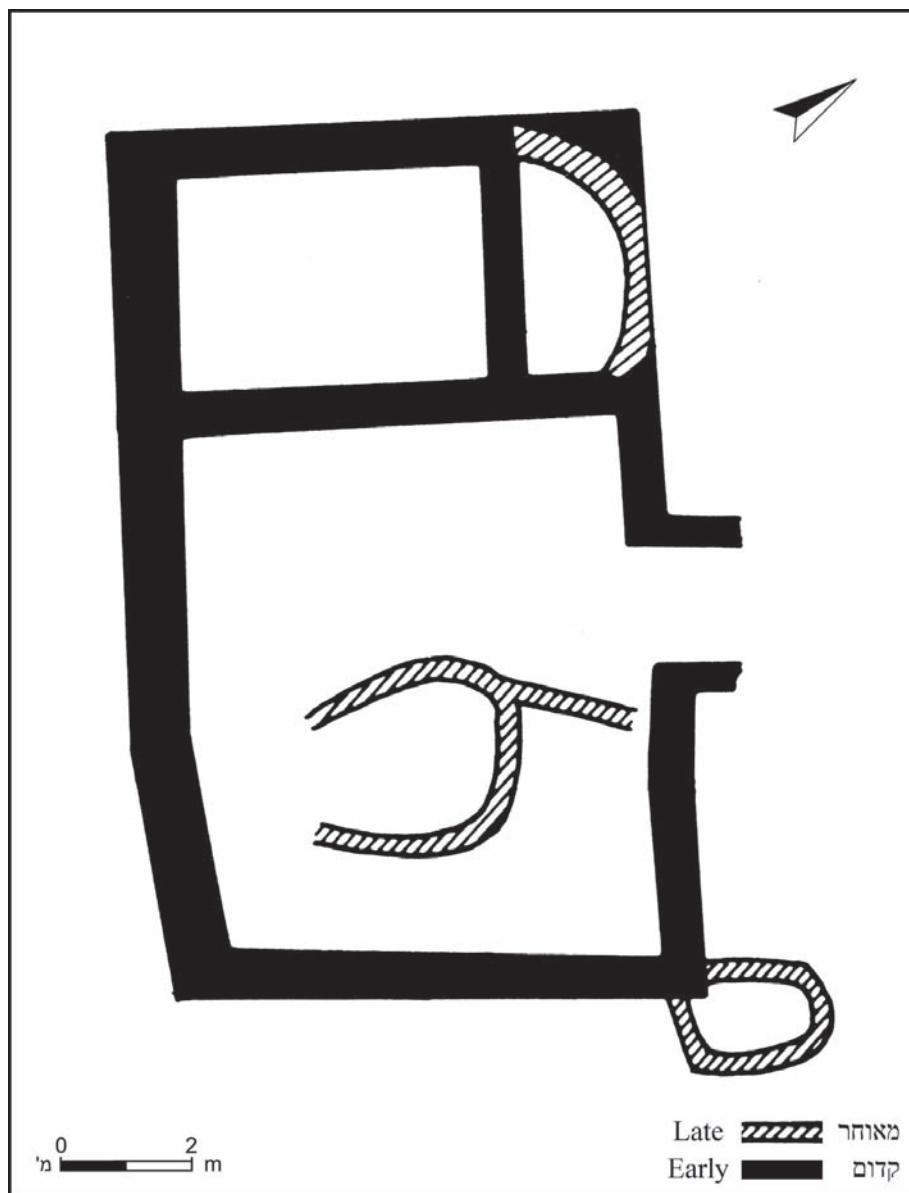
is built of large, unhewn stones. It contains a court (southeast) and two rooms (northwest). Upper round and oval small rooms, built of pebbles, may represent a later stage. Next to the site are some

hewn, agricultural installations.

Pottery: MA – 100%.

The place is a farmhouse along the edge of the Buqe'ah, founded and existed in the Middle Ages.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 152.



312. Plan of Kh. Umm Butmeh with its two stages.

Site 142: 19 – 18/72/1

'Iraq el-Asbah

Israel grid: 1976 1829

UTM grid: 7359 5699

Elevation: 70 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: caves

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 7 km distantNearest road: Buqeï'ah – Argaman
junction (C21), passes by site

Visibility: 2

May 19, 1982, Apr. 1, 1990, 29
shards

* * *

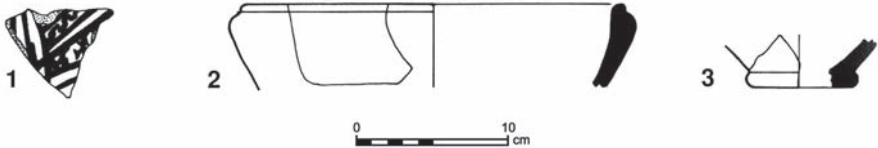
Cave dwellings on the northern edge of the Buqeï'ah, about 2 km southeast of Moshav Ro'i. They are located in a small, internal ravine.

The caves with settlement remains are above the ravine. Dump with remains including shards, bones and other items is found in

front of the openings. The ceilings are all blacked from smoke. Dwelling caves with settlement remains, on the range above the site, were also found and checked.

Pottery: MA – 100% (in the cave dwellings).

Previous surveys: none.



313. Pottery from the cave dwellings at 'Iraq es-Asbah, from MA: 1. Dec shard, br on wh; 2. Bowl, gray; 3. Jug base, yel.

Site 143: 19 – 18/50/1

Khirbet Humsah

(on SWP map: Hute Saduneh; Guérin: Tell es-Safra)

Israel grid: 1955 1806

UTM grid: 7348 5677

Elevation: 67 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: historical place on map

Site type: fortress

Area: 5.1 dunams (1.28 acres)

Topography: valley edge, hilltop and saddle

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman junction (C21), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

May 19, 1982; Apr. 22, 1992; 66 shards

* * *

A site in a broad ravine, connecting the center of the Buqei'ah with Wadi el-Far'ah. It is located in the southern Buqei'ah, with high Ras Humsah towers it from the east.

Wadi Humsah begins there and continues south to Wadi el-Far'ah.

The well preserved complex, on a low hilltop, was presumably a fortress. It was fortified, at least in its

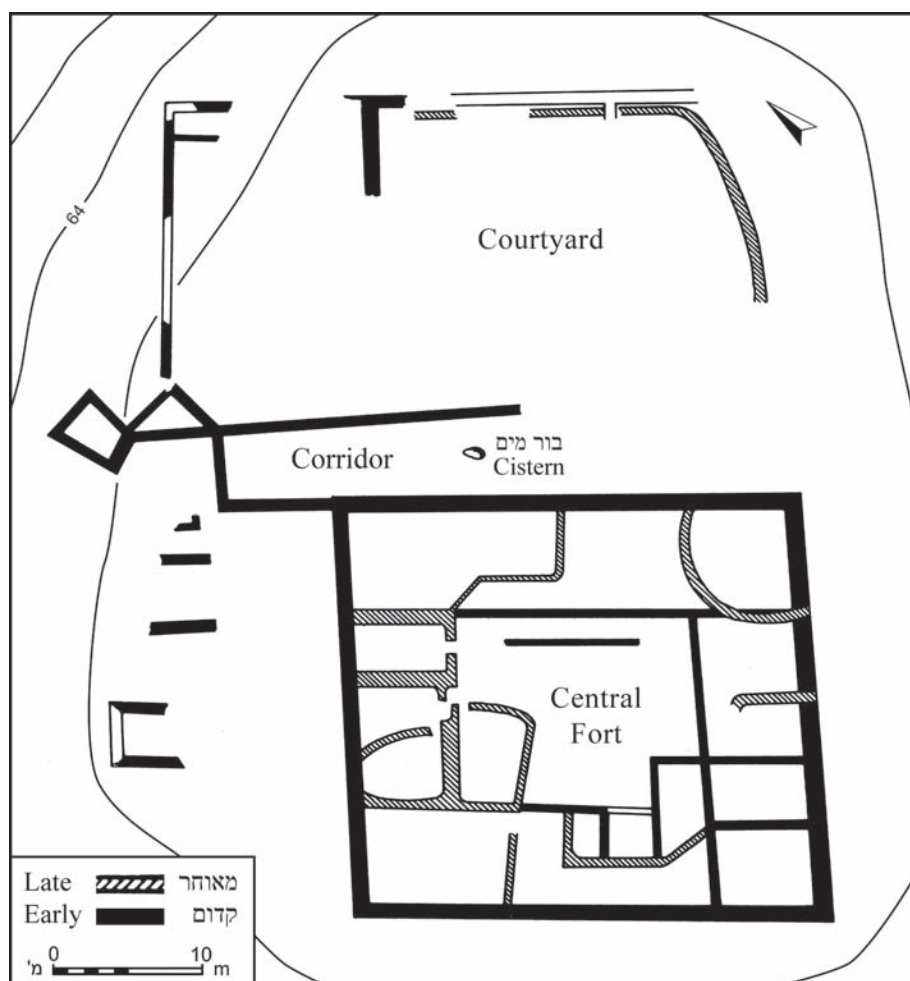


314. Bird's eye view of Kh. Humsah, viewed from the south. The fortress is on the hill at right; the dams are in the gorge at left.

original stage. It is well constructed of large, hewn stones. The nucleus is a square courtyard, about 33X33 m in size, surrounded by series of rooms. Northwest of this building there is a large courtyard, 40X25 m in size, less preserved than the square fort. In the vicinity of the court and the fort there are many remains of walls of dismantled buildings. The entrance into the complex was

through a long hallway running northwest – southeast, with a large cistern opening in its center. In a later stage (marked gray in fig. 315) several rooms were erected upon the original ones. Some 0.2 km east of the fortress, in a wadi, two well built dams were found, arranged one after the other. These were the water suppliers of the site.

Pottery: LR – 20%; Byz – 50%;



315. The fortress plan at Kh. Humsah.

EM – 20%; MA – 10%.

Coin find: Four coins, from LRA to the EM; see appendix.

Conder and Kitchener mention “remains of a structure and a pool”. It may have been Guérin’s Tel Zaphrah, where he mentions “a small hill, covered with medium and large sized stones, whose origin was ruined buildings”.

This seems to be a Roman – Byz-

antine Periods fortress of the *Castellum* type, several of which are known in the survey (cf. nos. 144, 266 in this volume)

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 166. They describe “remnants of solitary structures on a low hilltop, constructed from field stones”.

Bibliography: SWP II, 237; Guérin 1969 (IV), 253.



316. The upper dam near Kh. Humsah, looking southeast.



317. The fortress of Kh. Humsah, looking north, April 1993.



Site 144: 19 – 17/88/1

Khirbet Umm Kharaz (on SWP map: Kh. Umm Harraz)

Israel grid: 1980 1781

UTM grid: 7372 5646

Elevation: 8 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical place on map

Site type: fortress

Area: 2.6 dunam (0.65 acre)

Topography: valley edge and hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Colluvial – Alluvial; quality:

4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 3

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Buqeï'ah – Argaman
junction (C21), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

May 8, 1983; Mar. 20, 1992; 52

shards

A fortress in the southeastern Buqeï'ah. Nearby, Wadi Abu Sidreh begins its descent into the Jordan valley. There is a fine view from the site of the Jordan Valley, Ras Hum-

sah and the eastern Buqeï'ah.

The basic plan (apparently dating to the Roman – Byzantine Periods) is a square courtyard surrounded

by a massive wall 1.5–2 m wide. Originally measuring 35x35 m, in the present day only the southern half and sections of the surrounding wall have survived. The rest was destroyed by the Israel Defense Forces. In the center there is a massive structure of large stones (a tower), 10x10 m in size and 2 m high. Inside the fort and along the wall various rooms are discerned, with several hewn cisterns. At a later stage some structures were added on the outside. The northern slope is supported by wide terrace walls,

while on the southern one there are two large circles surrounded by walls, presumably threshing floors.

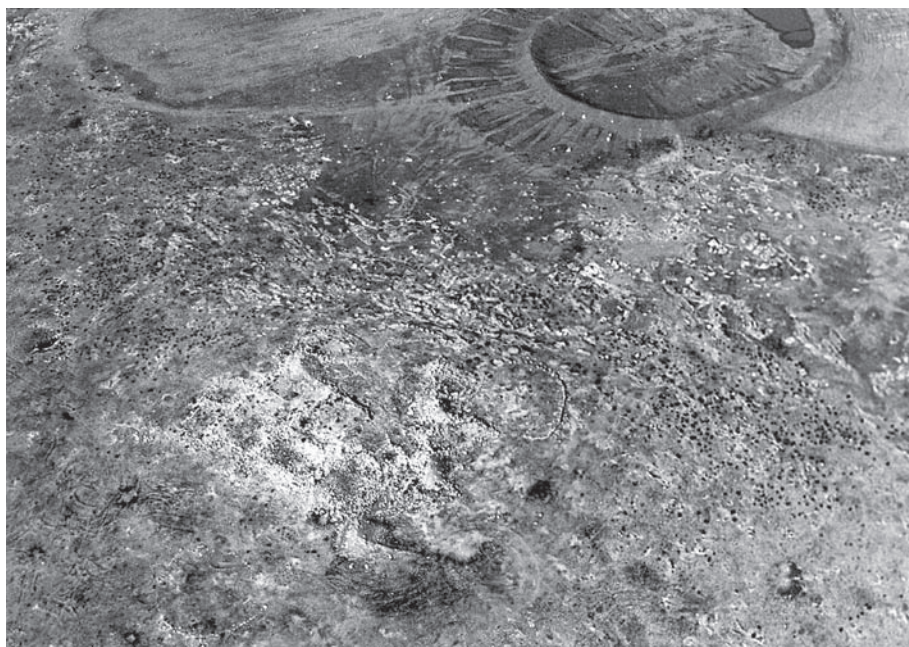
The plan is of the *castellum* type, with a central tower as in site no. 259. It seems to play a military role, possibly road control.

Pottery: IrA II – 5%; IrA III – 30%; LR – 10%; Byz – 40%; EM – 15%.

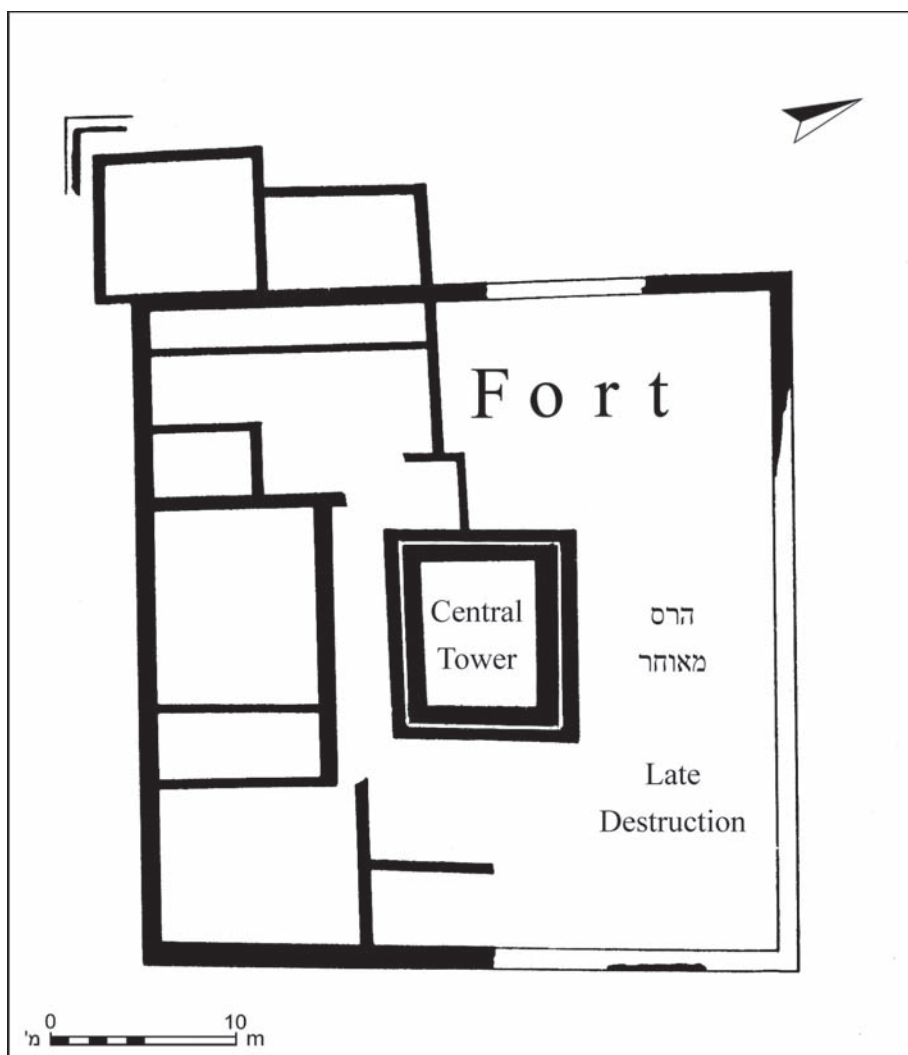
Flint find: see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: SWP II, 241.



318. The fortress of Kh. Umm Kharaz, after its partial destruction by the Israeli army. Above to the right is an army training installation, viewed to the west.



319. Plan and reconstruction of the Roman-Byzantine fortress at Kh. Umm Kharaz.

CHAPTER TEN

JEBEL TAMMUN

LANDSCAPE UNIT 18



Young women draw water in a traditional village
etching by P. Lortet (1884)

Site 145: 18 – 18/48/2

Abu Loz

Israel grid: 1841 1881

UTM grid: 5223 5748

Elevation: 342 m a.s.l., 150 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 1.1 dunams (0.28 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Qabatiyeh Junction (B5), 1 km distant

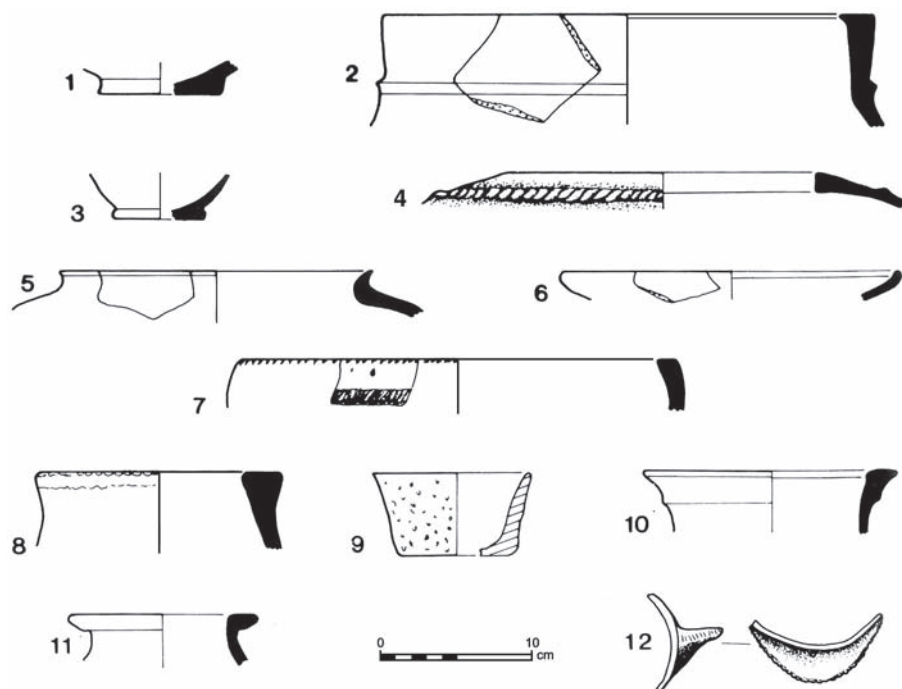
Visibility: 9

Dec. 9, 1982; 95 shards and 30 flint items

* * *

A site on a high summit on the western edge of the Tammun Range, about 2 km west of the vil-

lage of Tammun. The valley of Wadi el-Far'ah extends to the south and west of the site. There is a fine view



320. Pottery from Abu Loz: 1, 3. Bowl bases, yel, MBA II; 2. Especially large crater, br, 'Far'ah Family'; 4. HM jar with rope dec, EBA I; 5. Jar, yel, EBA I; 6. Bowl, yel, MBA II; 7. Bowl with toothed rim, lt br, 'Far'ah Family'; 8. Jar, br, 'Far'ah Family'; 9. Small bowl, basalt; 10. Jar, pk, MBA II; 11. Jug, pk, MBA II; 12. Toothed ledge handle, br, 'Far'ah Family'.

of these areas from the site.

The site is enclosed by a wall from the south, east and west. In the north there are bare rocks, suggesting an erosion of the wall. Inside there are few walls *in situ*, made of field stones, and building

stones. The site is especially rich in pottery.

Pottery: Chal – 40%; EBA I – 40%; MBA II – 20%.

Flint find: see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 146: 18 – 18/17/1

el-‘Ajjam

Israel grid: 1813 1875

UTM grid: 7225 5744

Elevation: 342 m a.s.l., 70 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient but does not appear on map

Site type: enclosure

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 5

Cultivation: uncultivated and field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1 km distant

Visibility: 7

Mar. 21, 1983; 11 shards

An oval enclosure on an isolated, rocky hill on the western edge of the Tammun Range, about 1.5 km west – southwest of the village of Tammun. Nearby is a pass (*naqb*) between Tammun and Tel el-Far‘ah. No sheikh’s tomb, as indicated in the map, exists here.

The 1.8 m wide surrounding wall

is built from very large boulders. Some of them, on the bottom of the wall, are 1.0x0.6 m in size. On top of these there is a later layer of small field stones. The entrance is a built opening, with two stages as well, located on the east side. The area inside is basically empty, with few walls and fallen monoliths. The shards find is extremely sparse. On

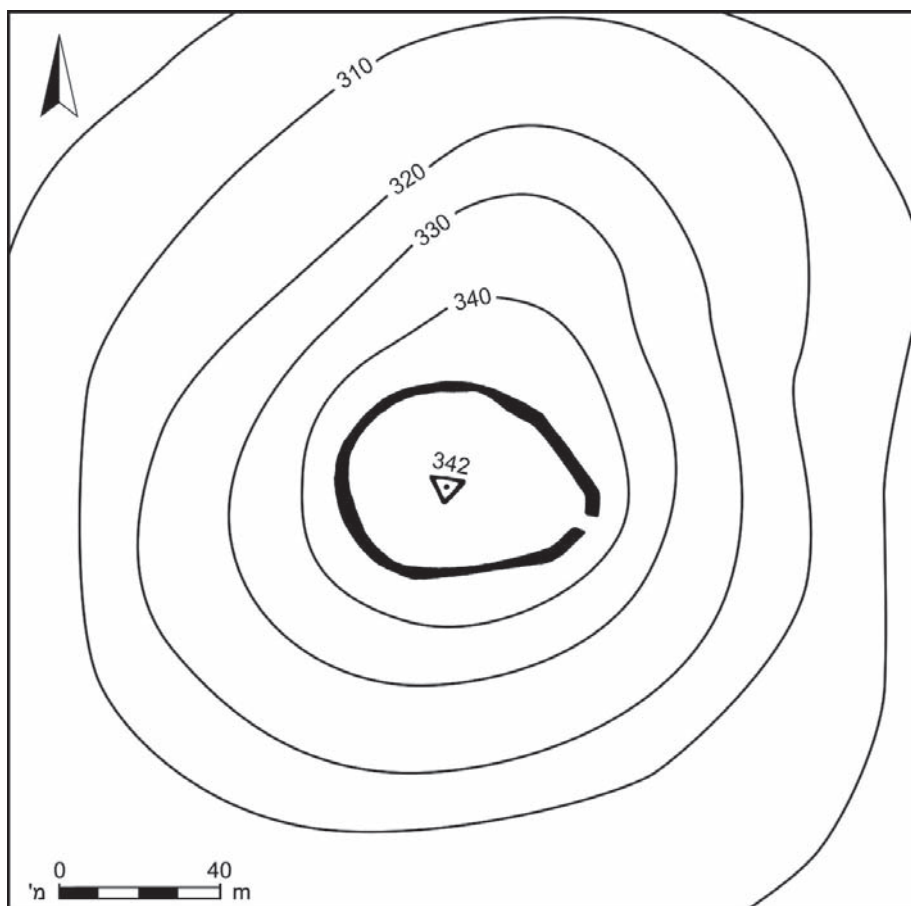


321. Pottery from el-‘Ajjam, all MBA I: 1. Jar, br ; 2. Ledge handle; 3. HM jar, yel.

a saddle east of the pass are round
tumuli without any shards.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no.
42.

Pottery: MBA I – 100%.



322. The el-'Ajjam enclosure plan.



323. The Middle Bronze Age I enclosure on the el-‘Ajjam summit, looking north, 1993. The rocky place is difficult to approach. The path from Tammun to Wadi el-Far‘ah is in the left, on the saddle.



Site 147: 18 – 18/75/1

Qabr ‘Abush

Israel grid: 1877 1856

UTM grid: 7259 5725

Elevation: 590 m a.s.l., 300 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient but does not appear on map

Site type: small ruin, structure and cairn

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: high summit and ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 10

Mar. 2, 1982; 22 shards

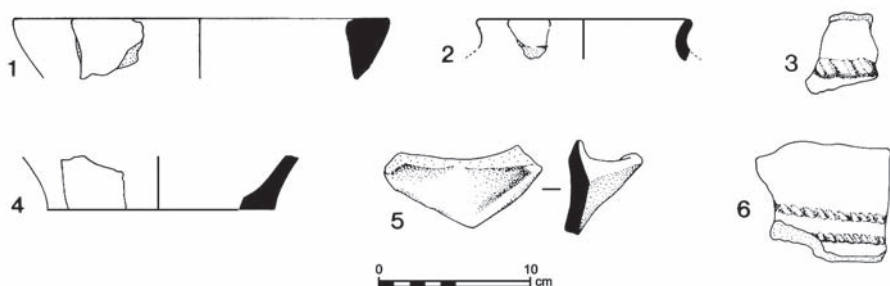
A site on the highest summit of Jebel Tammun (590 m above sea level), with a very fine view of the entire valley of Wadi el-Far'ah. Also seen are Tel el-Far'ah, the Buqei'ah and Ras Jadir.

There is a pile of stones (a tomb or dismantled *tumulus*) with a new stone fence nearby. East of these is a cleared field, surrounded by a

stone fence. On the eastern slope an elongated structure, 10x19 m in size, was discerned, similar to the structure at "the *Kurgan*" (site no. 148 here). To the west is a hewn, Byzantine Period type winepress. Most of the shards were collected on the northern slope.

Pottery: MBA I – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



324. Pottery from Qabr 'Abush, all MBA I: 1. Bowl, br; 2. Jar, gray; 3, 6. Rope dec, yel; 4. Jar base, yel; 5. Folded ledge handle, dk.



Site 148: 18 – 18/94/1

el-Khellaiyel ("The *Kurgan*")

Israel grid: 1893 1849

UTM grid: 7276 5718

Elevation: 540 m a.s.l., 250 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin, structure and cairn

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)

Topography: high summit and ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: grumosoles and rendzina; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tel el-Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 10

Mar. 18, 1982; Dec. 21, 1988; Apr. 21, 1993; 122 shards and six flint items

A site on a high summit of Jebel Tammun, to the east of a narrow, rocky saddle. There is a very fine view to Wadi el-Far'ah.

The site consists of three parts:

1. A pyramid-like hillock ("Kurgan"), 25 m in diameter and 6 m high. It is basically composed of remains of ash and burnt bones, together with dirt and stones. Inside are structural remains, with many shards scattered nearby.

2. Some 120 m northwest of the "kurgan" is an elongated structure of large boulders, 5x25 m in size. It is divided into two halls of unequal length. Close to it is a smaller *tumulus*.

3. 50 m north of the "Kur-

gan" there is a large, empty burial cave with steps leading into it. In the area of the long structure two dismantled circles of stones were found. Long walls extend to the northwest of the complex, but their connection to it is unclear. To the north of the site there is also a hewn basin.

The site is exceptional in its location and structure, with a most varied pottery. All characteristics suggest a cultic center with fire sacrificial activities.

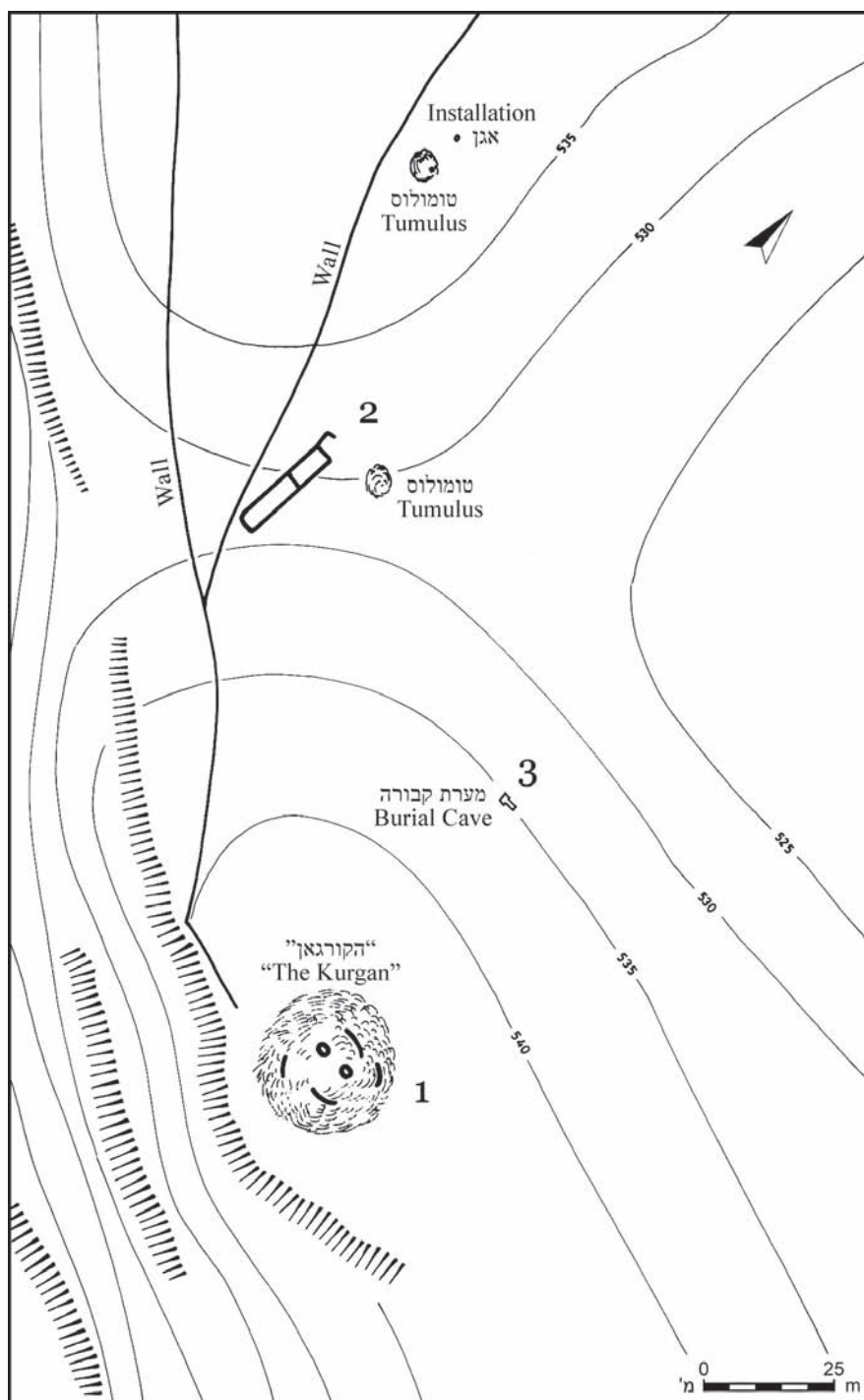
Pottery: Chal – EBA I ('Far'ah Family') – 30%; MBA I – 20%; MBA IIB – 25%; LB I – 25%.

Flint find: Six undefined items.

Previous surveys: none.



325. An overall picture, from the west, of the cultic site at el-Khellaiyel ("The Kurgan"). The large pile of ash (on which the figure stands) is on the cliff of Jebel Tammun, which descends southward into Wadi el-Far'ah. 1985.



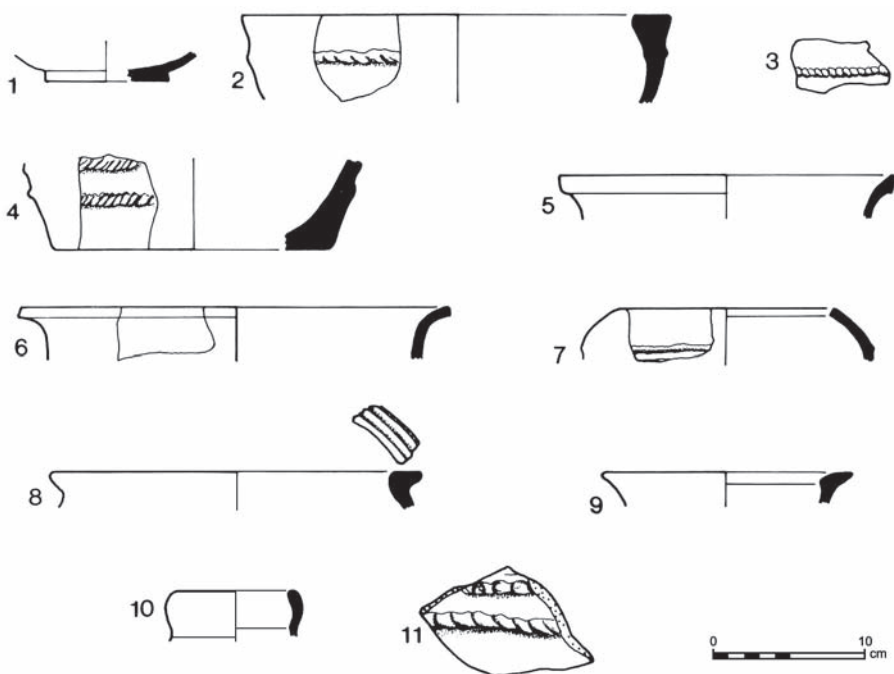
326. Plan of the el-Khellaiyel complex. In the center is "The Kurgan" and above it, to the northwest, the elongated structure and the *tumuli* near it.



327. "The *Kurgan*" - a pile of ash and bone fragments, the central part of the site of el-Khellaiyel, looking north. At right, in the distance, are the ranges of Jebel Tammun. 1986.



328. The elongated structure at el-Khellaiyel, looking north. In the distance are the ranges of Jebel Tammun. 1986.



329. Pottery from el-Khellaiyel: 1. Bowl base, lt, MBA II; 2, 4. Bowls, br, rope dec, 'Far'ah Family'; 5-6. CP, dk, LB; 7. HM jar, gray, MBA I; 8. Bowl, pk, MBA II; 9. Jar, lt, MBA II; 10. Jug, br, LB; 3, 11. Rope dec, br, 'Far'ah Family'.



Site 149: 18 – 18/95/1

Khirbet Umm el-Kubesh (also on SWP map)

Israel grid: 1898 1852

UTM grid: 7281 5721

Elevation: 470 m a.s.l., 200 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient but does not appear on map

Site type: small ruin and farm

Area: 1.6 dunams (0.4 acre)

Topography: plateau

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: grumosoles and rendzina; quality: 4

Cultivation: uncultivated and field crops

Cisterns: 4

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 8 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa'ot junction (C20), 1 km distant

Visibility: 9

Mar. 18, 1982; Apr. 21, 1993; 41 shards

A farm-complex on a small summit on the edge of a plateau. It is located on the second, northeastern, step of Jebel Tammun, with a fine view of the entire Buqe'ah and Ras Jadir.

The central feature is a large structure, about 45x44 m in size; it compose of an inner courtyard with wings of rooms around. In the southern side there is a small courtyard surrounded by rooms. The inner masonry is of ashlar, while other walls are of hewn field stones. In the western part is a long courtyard; a building with three rooms protrudes westward from the enclosure wall. In the northeastern wing, the shortest one, nine rooms with openings and doorposts *in situ* were found. Another long courtyard separates the northeastern courtyard

from the southern one. A separate, small structure with three rooms is located slightly southeast of the structure. Some 40 m to the south-east there is an agricultural complex, with three threshing floors and two structures, one with rooms, between them. Due to its remoteness, the place is very well preserved.

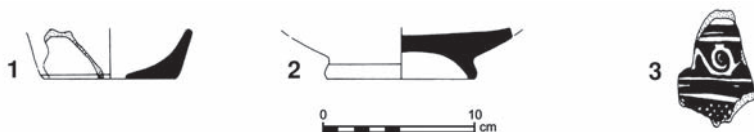
In the center of the site there are two olive presses *in situ* and a hewn wine cellar. Northeast of it there are a burial cave and a hewn trough.

The site represents a full scale farming complex. The pottery finds suggest the Middle Ages as the most important period.

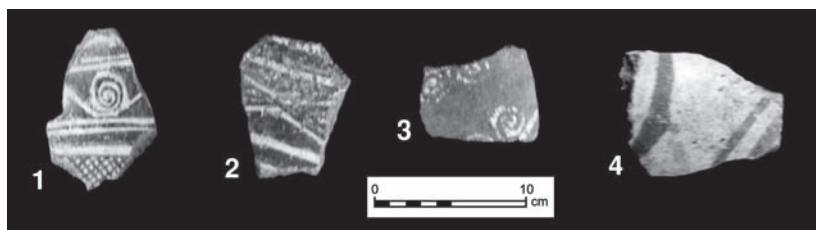
Pottery: Byz – 25%; EM – 20%; MA – 55%.

Previous surveys: none.

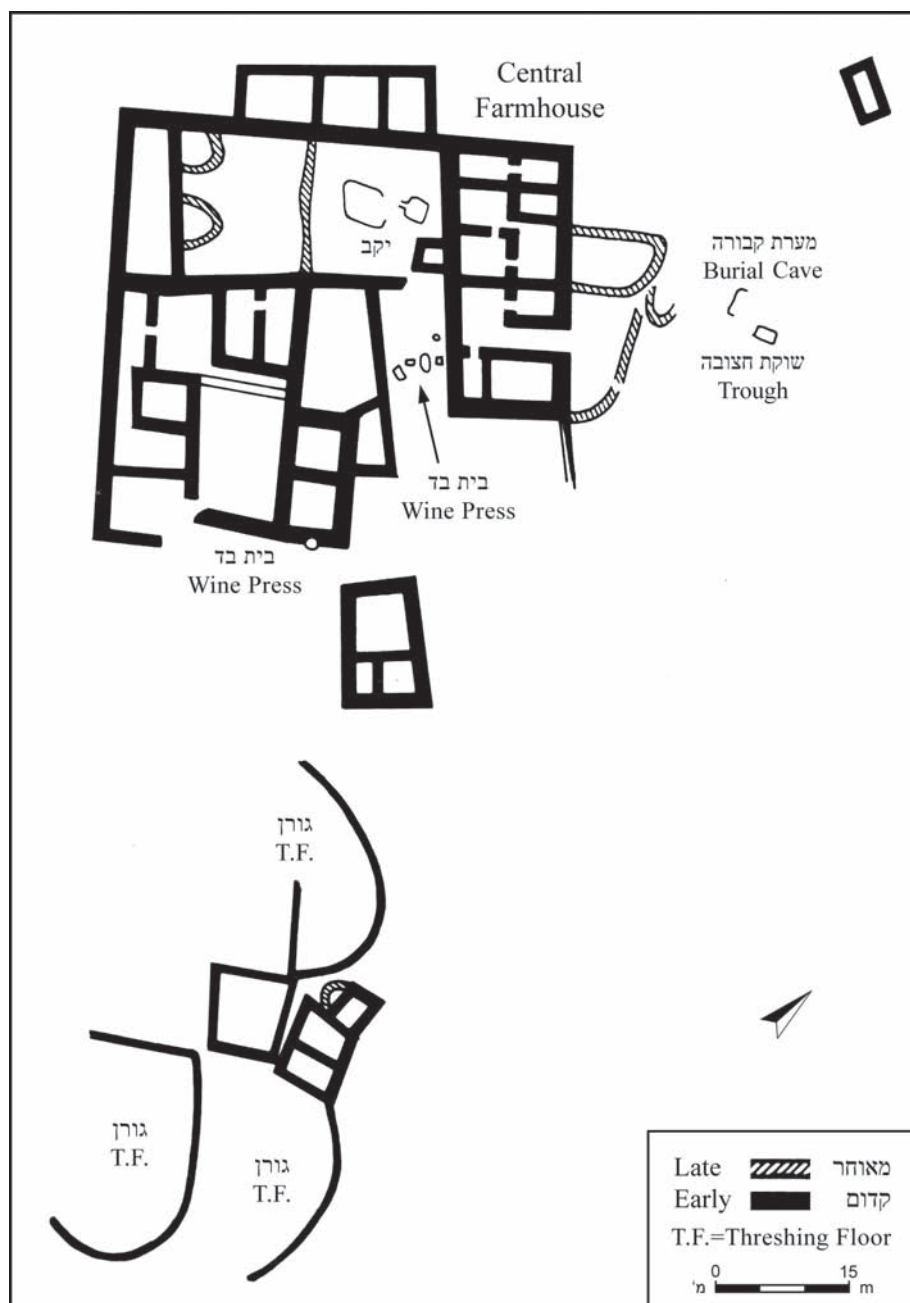
Bibliography: SWP II, 241.



330. Pottery from Kh. Umm el-Kubesh: 1-2. Bowl bases, EM; 3. Decorated shards, Mameluk.



331. Kh. Umm el-Kubesh: decorated shards from the Mameluk Period, violet on white.



332. Plan of Kh. Umm el-Kubesh. Note the oil press installations in the courtyard and the array of threshing floors southeast of the farm.



333. Aerial photo (looking east) of the farm complex at Kh. Umm el-Kubesh, on the northeastern slope of Jebel Tammun. Winter 1993.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

WADI EL-FAR'AH

LANDSCAPE UNIT 19



A deep wadi in the Samaria area, by W. H. Bartlett

Site 150: 18 – 18/28/1

Burj el-Far'ah (on SWP map: Burj el Farah)

Israel grid: 1829 1883

UTM grid: 7206 5750

Elevation: 195 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as ancient site

Site type: tell and fortress

Area: 8 dunams (2 acres)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 3

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 0.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Qabatiyeh junction (B5), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

Dec. 10, 1982; 41 shards

* * *

A tell and a fortress at the edge of a narrow ridge, whose steep slopes descend into Wadi el-Far'ah. The site is located about 1 km east of *Tel el-Far'ah*.

The fortress stands on a small tell

whose terraces have been preserved until today. Only the northern part of the ridge is attached to its environs. On the southern edge there is a relatively well-preserved medieval fortress, 25x30 m in size and



334. The tell and fortress at Burj el-Far'ah, looking northwest. Note the prominent wall, the fortified place, and the moat. 1993.

separated from the ridge by a moat, about 4-5 m wide and 2 m deep. The fortress consists of a central courtyard surrounded by rooms, with a tower wall standing to 8 m high. The good masonry is of hewn stones with mortar.

In the area are many shards.

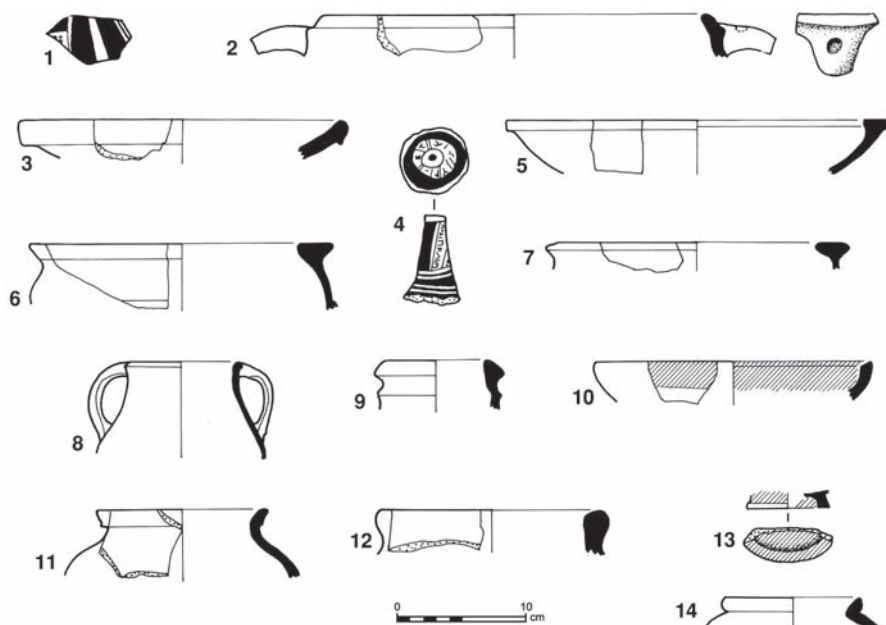
Pottery: IrA II – 30%; IrA III – 10%; Per – 10%; Hel – 15%; ER – 5%; MA – 30%.

Burj el-Far'ah, continued from Iron Age II until the Middle Ages, was apparently intended to protect

the springs. The place is not mentioned in the Crusader or Moslem sources of the Middle Ages. The British Surveyors describe "a square tower of small dimensions. It was apparently built as a guard tower and is not older than the Saracenic Period". Guérin mentions "a square tower, 20 by 20 paces".

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 115.

Bibliography: Guérin 1969 (IV), 259-261; SWP II, 234-235; Ilan 1973, 362-363.



335. Pottery from Burj el-Far'ah: nos. 2, 6-10 – IrA II; 1. Jar body shard, Byz; 2. CP, br; 3. Bowl, gray, Per; 4. Dec jug, violet on wh, MA; 5. Bowl, br, ER; 6-7. HM jars, br; 8. Jug, yel; 9. Ridged jar, gray/orange; 10. Bowl, red slip; 11. Jar, yel, Hel; 12. Bowl, MA; 13. Jar base, Sigillata, ER; 14. Jug, Hel.

Site 151: 18 – 18/28/2

Tel el-Far'ah (on SWP map: Tell el Farah)

Israel grid: 1821 1881	luvial; quality: 6
UTM grid: 7214 5749	Cultivation: field crops
Elevation: 150 m a.s.l., l.s.a.	Cisterns: 22
Name type: on map as ancient site	Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), next to site
Site type: fortified tell	Nearest road: Far'ah – Qabatiyeh junction (B5), passes by site
Area: 80 dunams (20 acres)	Visibility: 3
Topography: valley edge and hilltop	Dec. 10, 1982; 56 shards
Rock type: Judah formation	
Soil type: terra rossa and colluvial-al-	

* * *

A large tell on the western edge of Wadi el-Far'ah. It is separated from the plain by steep ravines in the north, and approached via a saddle (west). Around the place there are two rich springs – 'Ain el-Far'ah (east) and 'Ain ed-Dilb (south).

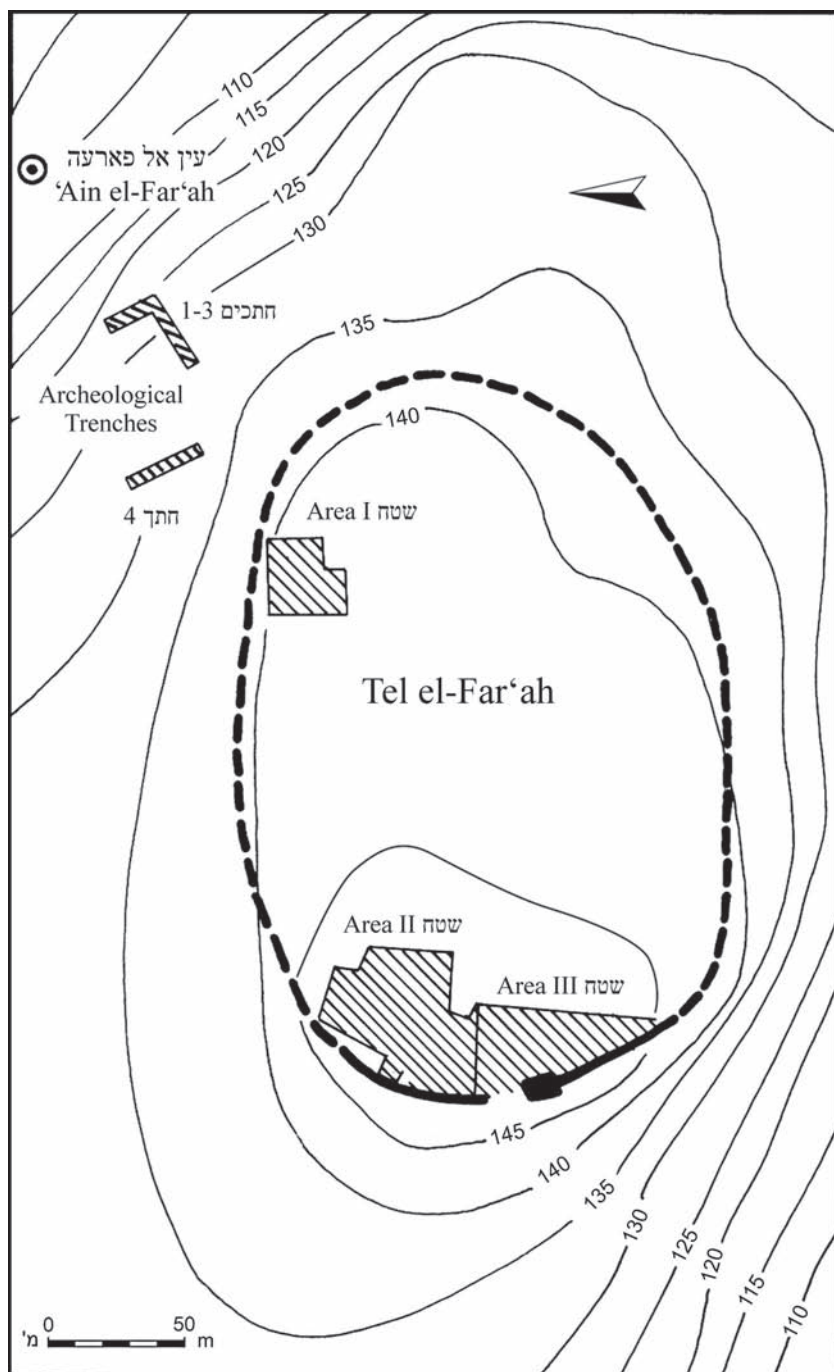
Excavations by the French Expedition under the direction of R. de Vaux, between 1948 and 1963, uncovered large fortifications (a wide wall and gate) and a city dated to the Early Bronze Age I-II. Following a prosperous period during Middle Bronze Age IIB, the city much shrank during Late Bronze Age II. The small Iron Age I settlement is dated to the 11th Century B.C.E. During the Israelite Kingdom (Iron Age II) the city, which became for a short period the capital of the northern kingdom, prospered again, just to be destroyed and burnt during the revolt of

Omri (ca. 870 B.C.E.). Then, the capital was moved to the Samaria. Around the tell several cemeteries and tombs were unearthed by the French expedition.

Pottery: Neolithic – 5%; Chal – 5%; EBA I – 5%; EBA II – 20%; EBA III – 5%; EBA IV – 5%; MBA I – 5%; MBA IIB – 5%; LB I – 3%; LB II – 5%; LB III – 5%; IrA IC – 2%; IrA II – 20%; IrA III – 5%; Per – 5%.

Albright identified the tell with *Tirzah* (Joshua 12:24; I Kings 14: 17; 15:21; etc), the capital of the Kings of Israel. This identification was accepted after the French Expedition excavations; see chapter three.

Bibliography: de Vaux, R., and Steve, A. M., 1947; 1948-1949; 1951; 1952; 1955; 1957; 1961-1962; De Vaux 1992; Chambon 1984; Mallet 1987.



336. Tel el-Far'ah - the tell and the excavation areas.

Drawn after Chambon 1984, Plate 4.

Site 152: 18 – 18/47/2

Wadi esh-Sha'ab

Israel grid: 1842 1875	nean brown forest soil; quality: 3
UTM grid: 7223 7543	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., 8 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
Site type: shard scatter	(no. 104), 1 km distant
Area: 8 dunams (2 acres)	Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2
Topography: valley edge and slope	km distant
Rock type: Judah formation	Visibility: 3
Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-	July 5, 1982; 12 shards

* * *

A site on a step, about 2 km east of Tel el-Far'ah. It is located where Wadi esh-Sha'ab enters the plain of Wadi el-Far'ah.

A small shard scatter was found on the natural step near the wadi, which descends from Jebel Tam-

mun. There is also a three-wall structure, made of large field stones, with no shards nearby. The relation of the shards and the structure is unclear.

Pottery: Neolithic – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 153: 18 – 18/36/1

Khirbet esh-Sheikh Smett (A)

(on SWP map: Kh. Es Smeit and in Guérin: Kh. A'sir)

Israel grid: 1835 1867	nean brown forest soil; quality: 8
UTM grid: 7218 5735	Cultivation: uncultivated and field
Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., l.s.a.	crops
Name type: historical site on map	Cisterns: 28
Site type: large ruin and sheikh's tomb	Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
Area: 16 dunams (4 acres)	no. 104, 0.6 km distant
Topography: valley	Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1
Rock type: alluvium covering	km distant
Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-	Visibility: 3
	July 5, 1982; 49 shards

A site and a sheik's tomb on the upper, northwestern part of Wadi el-Far'ah valley, about 2 km southeast of Tel el-Far'ah and in the center of a small plain (Sahl Figas).

There are good many ruined structures, mostly built of large, hewn stones; in some of them the plaster has also been preserved. The tomb of Sheikh Smett, in the south-east part, contains a half-ruined structure with *mikhrab*, supported by two columns in secondary use, one made of marble. An upside-down other column base there was used as a column capital. Next to the structure is a paved courtyard with a cistern and gutter. To the south of

the ruin several hewn, agricultural installations were discovered. Many walls are *in situ*, with pieces of glass and rough mosaic stones.

Pottery: Byz – 60%; EM – 10%; MA – 30%.

Guérin notes the sheik's tomb and names it Kharbet A'sir, which he connects with Asher (Joshua 17:7). SWP members describe "Walls, apparently modern, with a dome, possibly ancient, and a column with a capital."

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 48; Knierim 1969, no. 2.

Bibliography: SWP II, 240; Guérin 1969 (IV), 261.



337. The tomb of esh-Sheikh Smett, looking west. Summer 1982.

Site 154: 18 – 18/46/1

ej-Jelameh

Israel grid: 1840 1868

UTM grid: 7222 5745

Elevation: 140 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: known as historical but does not appear on map

Site type: small ruin

Area: 1.8 dunams (0.45 acre)

Topography: valley edge and valley

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-

nean brown forest soil; quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

July 5, 1982; 41 shards

* * *

A small site on an eastern slope, between Wadi el-Far'ah and the western ranges of Jebel Tammun. Some 0.3 km to the west is esh-Sheikh Smett (site no. 153 here).

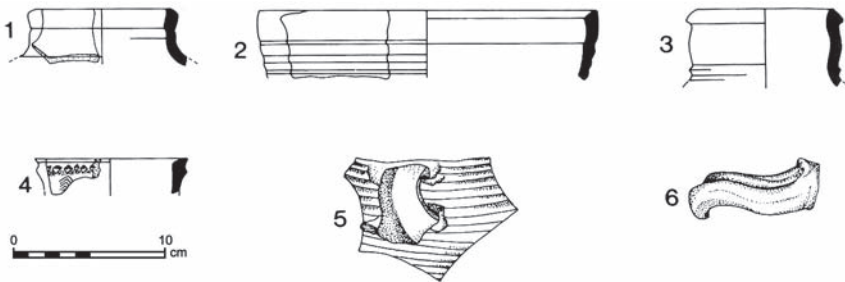
A few remains of walls made of hewn stones, with scatter of pottery and glass fragments, mark the remains. On the slope there are built

steps, and in the wadi below is a concentration of cisterns.

This may have been a large farm or a structure related to the central site of Kh. esh-Sheikh Smett nearby.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



338. Pottery from ej-Jelameh, all Byz: 1, 3. Jars, br; 2. Bowl, lt. br; 4. Dec jug, yel; 5. Jar handle, dk; 6. 'frying pan' handle, dk.



339. The Byzantine Period site of ej-Jalameh, looking west. The remains are on the low hill in the foreground. Summer 1982.



Site 155: 18 – 18/36/2

Khirbet esh-Sheikh Smett (B)

Israel grid: 1833 1867

UTM grid: 7215 5735

Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 30 dunams (7.5 acres)

Topography: slope and valley

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-

nean brown forest soil; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1
km distant

Visibility: 2

July 5, 1982; 87 shards

* * *

A large site on the upper, northwestern part of Wadi el-Far'ah, about 2 km southeast of Tel el-Far'ah. The original settlement extended over

the plain and slopes, and only on the small, northern part the later ruin and the tomb of Sheikh Smett were built (site no. 153 here).

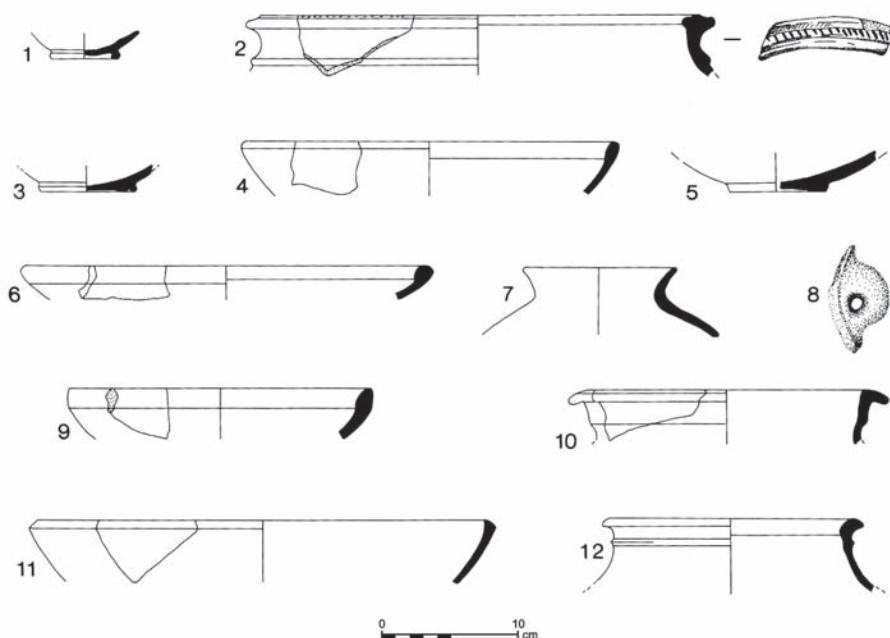
The remains of dozens of buildings *in situ*, built of field stones, are discerned. They are spread over five large, artificial steps. On the southern slope a possible fortification wall of large stones was found. Building stones are also scattered about.

The site was the main settlement in the area during Middle Bronze

Age I, and a possible “mate” of Tel el-Far’ah. In 1969 Knierim visited here, but did not differentiate between the earlier and the later site. Porath also included both in one site.

Pottery: Chal – 2%; MBA I – 40%; MBA IIB – 58%.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 48; Knierim 1969, no. 2.



340. Pottery from the Middle Bronze Age site of esh-Sheikh Smett (B): nos. 7-8 – MBA I, the rest – MBA IIB: 1. Bowl base, yel; 2. Bowl with dec on rim, yel; 3. Bowl base, br; 4, 6. Bowls, yel; 7. Jar, gray; 8. Jar handle, yel; 9, 11. Bowls, yel; 10, 12. Jars, br.

Site 156: 18 – 18/05/1

Khirbet Farweh (Kh. 'Ain el-Beidan)

Israel grid: 1802 1850

UTM grid: 7179 5722

Elevation: 168 m a.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name type: historical site but not on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 20 dunams (5 acres)

Topography: narrow ridge between wadis

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 12

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Beidan, no. 83), near the site

Nearest road: Shechem – Far'ah (B2), passes by site

Visibility: 2

Mar. 11, 1985; 70 shards

* * *

A large site in a narrow ravine and on a ridge, adjacent to the good springs of 'Ain el-Beidan and 'Ain Kudeira. The road descending from Shechem to Wadi el-Far'ah pass

nearby. The site is enclosed by high Mount Ebal (west) and by Wadi Sajur (south). The area of the site is populated now by stores and cafés, where the road sharply bends.



341. View to the west of Kh. Farweh and its environs. In the center of the photo is deep Wadi Abrad; to its left is Jebel Kebir, with the slopes of Mount Ebal and the road to Shechem to the right. 1989.

At various places in the sections along the road ruined structures, floors, building stones and pieces of marble are visible. There are also ashlar, pillars and a base in the Attic style, ceramic pipes for water and a Corinthian capital in a yard near the road. An eroded rectangular structure, with walls of ashlar and field stones alternately, is found at grid point 1809/1851. Its doorpost is also made of one ashlar. This structure is now a *Welli*, or a holy Sheik's tomb for the locals. Along the road there are openings of burial caves, one with a *sarcophagus*. About 0.5 km upwards there a group of Roman milestones, col-

lected together.

Pottery: EBA I – 10%; EBA II – 10%; Hel – 10%; ER – 15%; LR – 20%; Byz – 20%; EM – 5%; Ott – 5%; Mod – 5%.

This site composed a settlement and a roadside inn. The settlement is identified as Mishnaic *Bedan*, and see identifications. An inn and a roadside station named *Thera* stood here during the Crusader Period.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 64.

Bibliography: SWP II, 237; Beyer 1940, 173; Avi-Yonah 1963, 124; Reich 1991 (report on excavation of a tomb).



Site 157: 18 – 18/35/1

Khirbet es-Sirb (on SWP map: Kh. es Serb)

Israel grid: 1832 1855
UTM grid: 7225 5720
Elevation: 125 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.
Name type: on map as historical site
Site type: medium-sized ruin
Area: 8 dunams (2 acres)
Topography: ridge edge
Rock type: Judah formation
Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 7
Cultivation: none
Cisterns: 8
Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), near to site
Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), passes by site
Visibility: 6
Mar. 19, 1980; 40 shards

A medium-sized ruin on the edge of a narrow ridge, above the point where two branches of Wadi el-Far'ah meet.

There are many foundations of

field stones, yet most of the stones are concentrated in piles. Some wall corners, made of ashlar with holes for bolts, are preserved, with plenty of shards and broken glass.

Pottery: LR – 30%; Byz – 40%; 79; Kallai 1972, no. 1.
EM – 15%; MA – 15%.

Bibliography: SWP II, no. 240.

Previous surveys: Kappus 1966, 78-



342. Kh. es-Sirb (on the high hill in center), looking west. To the right and below are Wadi el-Far'ah and the road from Shechem to the Jordan Valley. Autumn 1985.



Site 158: 18 – 18/14/1

Khirbet el-Khrebat

(on SWP map: Ain Es-Subian; Kappus: Kh. el-Hurebe)

Israel grid: 1814 1846

UTM grid: 7206 5712

Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: on map as historical site

Site type: medium-sized ruin

Area: 6.5 dunams (1.63 acres)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 6

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.5 km distant

Nearest road: Shechem – Far'ah (B2),
0.5 km distant

Visibility: 5

Mar. 4, 1983; 68 shards

A site on a slope in the narrowest, southwestern part of the Wadi el-Far'ah valley, where the slopes of Jebel Kebir meet Wadi el-Beidan.

The site, on a narrow step, consists of two parts:

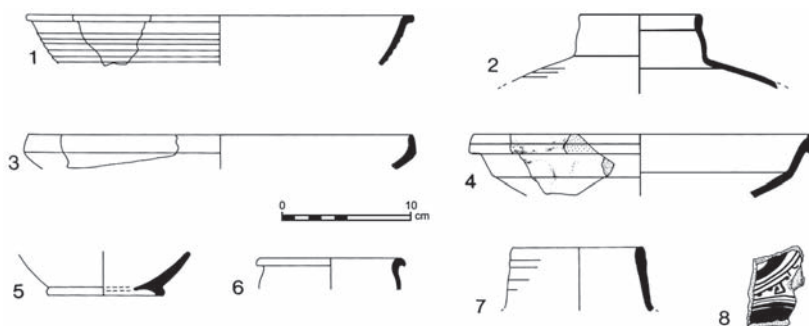
The first, main *khirbeh*, in the western side, contains structures of large, hewn stones. Nearby and beside are built terraces, caves, installations, cisterns and a large shard

scatter. East of the site is the second part, the cemetery. Here are many looted burial caves, a modern structure and terraces. Only few shards were found here.

Pottery: Byz – 5%; EM – 70%; MA – 25%.

Coin find: Three Medieval coins; see appendix.

Previous surveys: Kappus 1966, 77; Porath 1968, no. 66.



343. Pottery from Kh. el-Khreibat: 1-5. EM; 6-7. Byz; 8 – MA: 1. Bowl, gray; 2. Jar, dk gray; 3. Bowl, yel; 4. Bowl, green and bl glaze; 5. Jug base, br; 6-7. Jars, br; 8. Bowl shard, br dec on white.



Site 159: 18 – 18/34/1

Wa'ar el-Quf

Israel grid: 1831 1841

UTM grid: 7231 5708

Elevation: 175 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 2.8 dunams (0.7 acre)

Topography: valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;
quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(branch of Wadi Beidan, no. 104),
1 km distant

Nearest road: Shechem – Far'ah (B2),
1 km distant

Visibility: 4

Mar. 4, 1983; Jan. 15, 1984; 115
shards

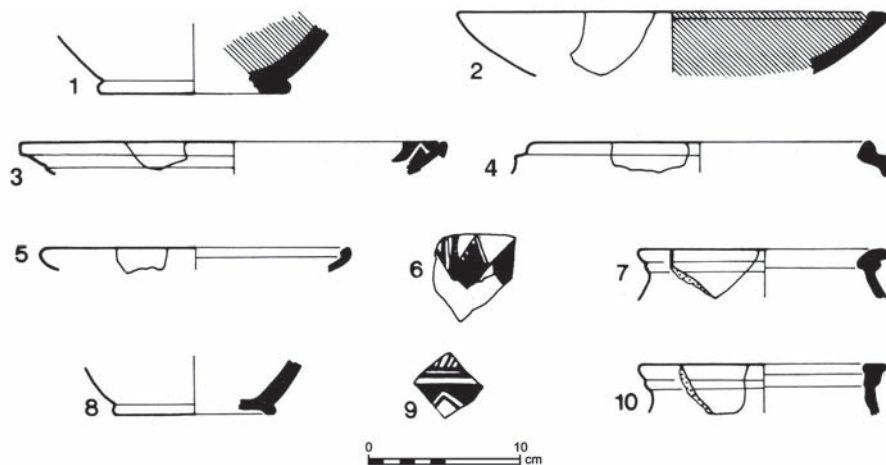
A site on the lower, southern step of the Wadi el-Far'ah valley, north of Jebel Kebir.

Near a rocky ravine, on an area of broad ridges, foundations of six structures were found in front of two large, hewn caves. Their walls, of hewn stones, are 1.5 m high. Above the step and caves are structures, installations and other caves.

On top of a site from Middle Bronze Age IIB and Iron Age II the small, rural settlement was established and abandoned between the 15th – 17th centuries C.E.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 30%; IrA II – 10%; MA – 40%; Early Ott – 20%.

Previous surveys: none.



344. Pottery from Wa'ar el-Quf: nos. 5, 7-8, 10 – MBA IIB; 4 – IrA II; 1-3, 6, 9 – MA: 1-3. Bowls, slip and dec; 4. CP, br; 5. Bowl, yel; 6, 9. Dec shards, br on wh and glaze; 7, 10. Jars, yel; 8. Bowl base, gray.

Site 160: 18 – 18/54/1

el-'Unuq

Israel grid: 1852 1840

UTM grid: 7244 5706

Elevation: 48 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 14.9 dunams (3.73 acres)

Topography: ridge edge and hilltop

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;
quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), near the site

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1
km distant

Visibility: 4

Feb. 10, 1983 and other visits; 174
shards

A large enclosure on a hilltop, isolated by ravines, in the Wadi el-Far'ah valley. The wadi flows to its north, in a narrow channel. The site is best approached through a saddle from the south, with a dirt road passes

0.3 km in the southeast.

The enclosure, elliptical in shape, is 250 m long and 70 m wide. It is surrounded by a well-built wall of large field stones. On the southeastern part of the wall there is a built



345. Aerial photo of the enclosure at el-'Unuq, looking northwest. Winter 1987.

entrance, with a presumed another one on the western wall.

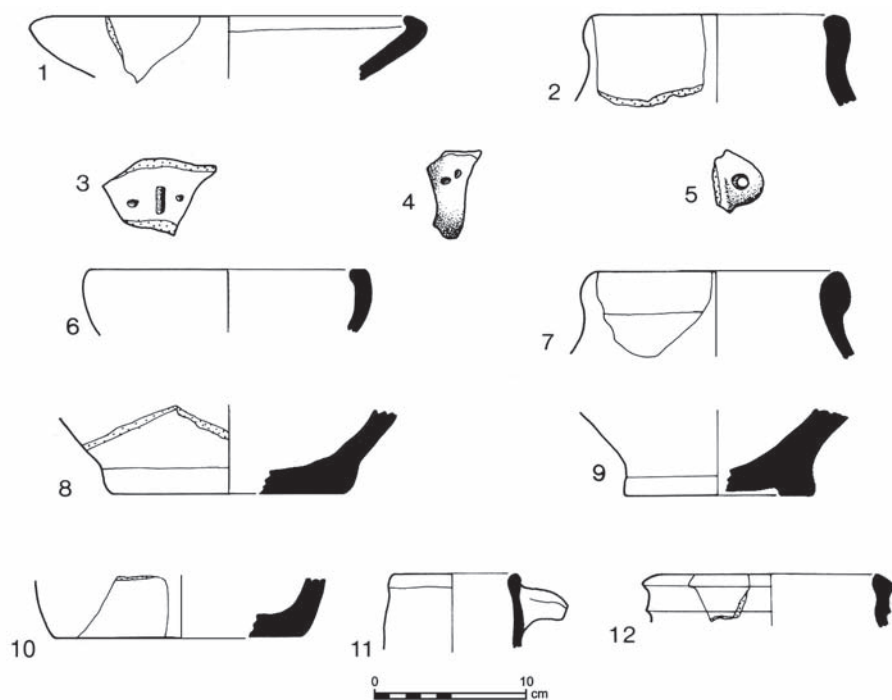
The enclosure is divided into two unequal parts: the large, southern one is about two thirds in area, while the smaller one is in the north. A dirt rampart, presumably covering a wall, separates them. Near and outside the southwestern tip is a 10x15 m rectangular structure. Other structures may have been built on the inside. In the middle of the southern tip there is a round stone pile 5 m in diameter, most probably covering a round structure. There is a small wall nearby.

This is possibly to be identified with a biblical *Gilgal*. If so, an identification with the one related to the road to Ebal and Garizim (Deuteronium 11: 29-30) can be suggested, and see chapter on identifications.

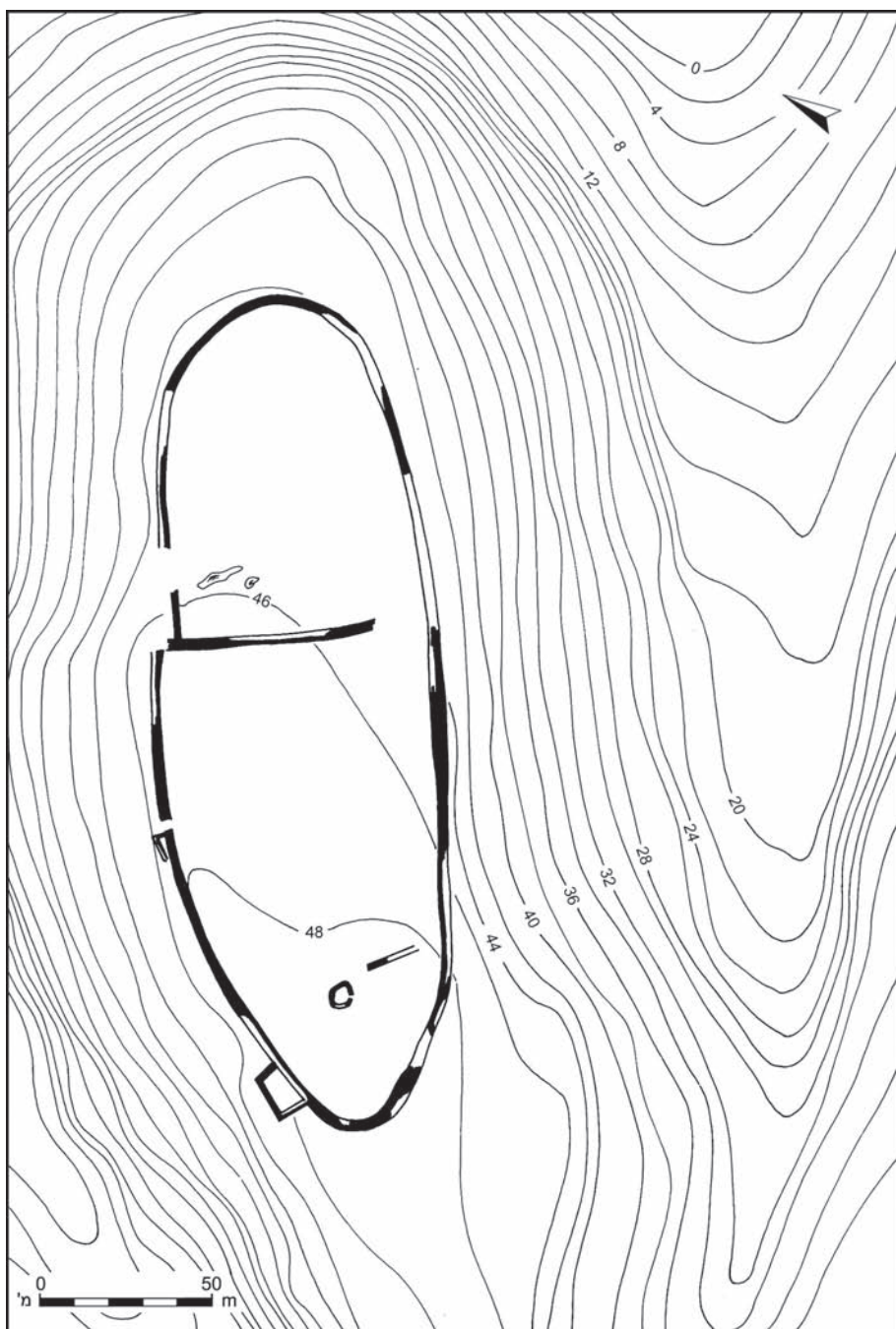
Pottery: IrA IA – 70%; “Eynun” – 20%; IrA II – 10%. Many shards with indented decoration and “human faces” were found; see ceramic introduction.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1988, 162 and no. 452.

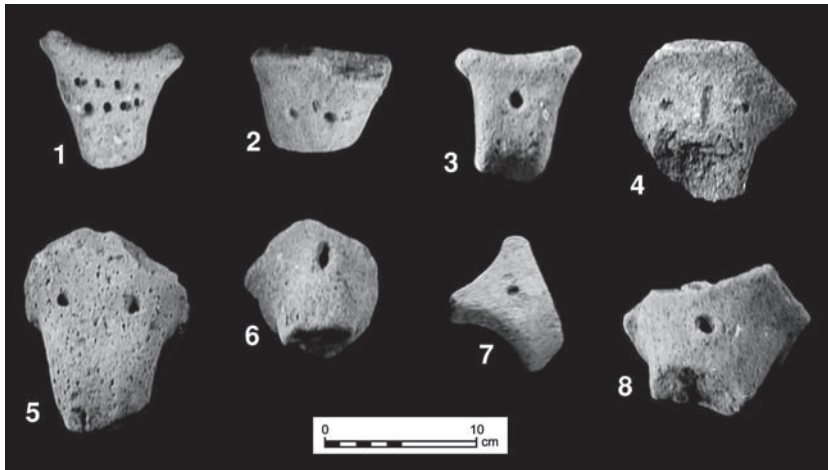
Bibliography: Zertal 1991, 38-43.



346. Pottery from el-'Unuq (all, except no. 12, IrA IA): 1. 'Manassite' bowl, br; 2, 7. Pythoi, br; 3, 4. Indented handles; 5. Pyxis handle, lt br; 6. Bowl, br; 8, 9. Crater bases, dk br; 10. Bowl base, br; 11. Jug, lt br; 12. Jar, black with orange outside, IrA II.



347. Plan of el-'Unuq. Note the 'sandal shape' form of the site.



348. Handles of jars and jugs with indented decoration, from the enclosure of el-'Unuq, IrA I.



Site 161: 18 – 18/74/2

Maqbarat en-Nuseriyyeh

Israel grid: 1870 1843

UTM grid: 7258 5709

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: ancient cemetery

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: rendzina; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 1.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1
km distant

Visibility: 5

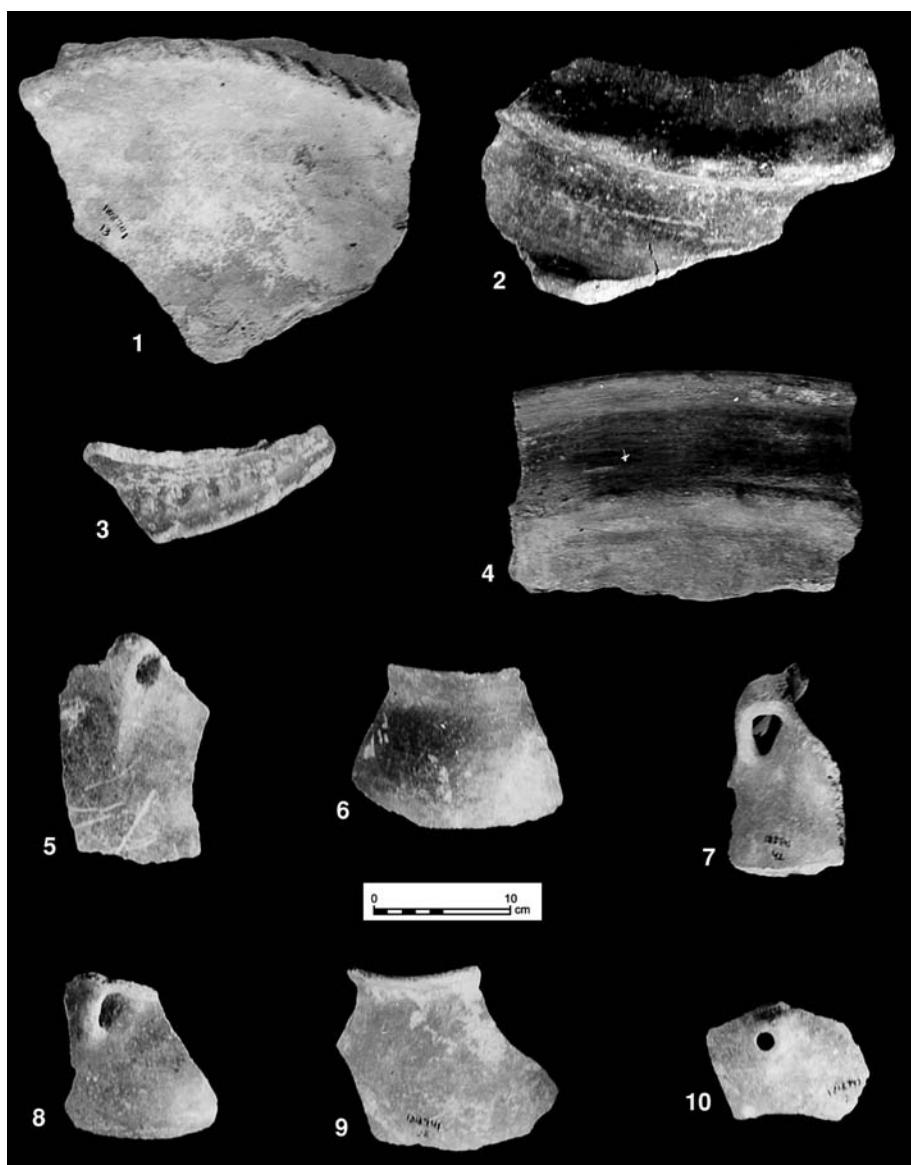
June 27, 1982; 54 shards

A looted cemetery in the southern foothills of Jebel Tammun.

See the description of el-Maqbarah (site no. 162 here).

Pottery: EBA I – 60%; MBA IIB – 10%; LB I – 15%; LB II – 15%.

Previous surveys: none.



349. Selected pottery from the looted cemeteries (Sites nos. 161-162): nos. 1-4 – 'Gray burnished' ware craters, EBI; nos. 5-10 – small jars with red slip, EBI.



350. The looted cemetery at Maqbarat en-Nuseriyyeh, with tomb openings and material removed from tombs. Large cemeteries are characteristic of the margins of Wadi el-Far'ah. 1982.



Site 162: 18 – 18/74/1

el-Maqbarah

Israel grid: 1879 1841

UTM grid: 7254 5712

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: ancient cemetery

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 1.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1
km distant

Visibility: 6

June 27, 1982; 81 shards

* * *

A burial area on the northern edge of the Wadi el-Far'ah valley in the low, southern edge of Jebel Tammun.

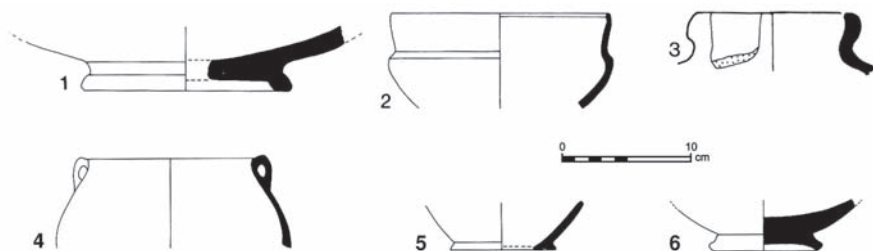
The cemeteries, in an advanced looting, extend over the lower ridges of Jebel Tammun. Hundreds of holes of shaft and tunnel caves, in

various stages of illegal excavations, are on the site. Many shards, including large fragments of vessels, are scattered outside the graves. Similar cemeteries extend eastwards, along

the foothills of Jebel Tammun.

Pottery: EBA I – 60%; MBA IIB – 10%; LB III – 10%; IrA I – 10%; IrA II – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.



351. Pottery from the cemetery at el-Maqbarah: 1. Crater base, IrA II; 2. Carinated bowl, yel, MBA IIB; 3. Jar, dk; 4. Small jar, EBA I; 5-6. Bowl bases, yel, MBA II.



Site 163: 18 – 18/84/1

el-Maqaber

Israel grid: 1885 1841

UTM grid: 7267 5709

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site but does not appear on map

Site type: ancient cemetery

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 6

June 27, 1982; 39 shards

A burial area in the southern foothills of Jebel Tammun. See the description of el-Magbarah (site no. 162 here).

Pottery: EBA I – 80%; LB III – 10%; IrA I – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.

Site 164: 18 – 18/43/3

Khirbet Umm Qasim (on SWP map: Kh. Umm el Kasim)

Israel grid: 1840 1832

UTM grid: 7233 5698

Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site but does not appear on map

Site type: medium-sized ruin

Area: 6.1 dunams (1.53 acres)

Topography: slope and ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 4

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Farr, no. 109), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 4

Feb. 12, 1983; 24 shards

* * *

A ruin at the bottom of a steep ravine, descending from Jebel Kebir northward to Wadi el-Far‘ah, on the second step above the river.

Some ten structures of large, slightly hewn stones, are on both sides of the ravine. They are well-laid on top of built terraces, with



352. A view from the east of Kh. Umm Qasim. The ruin is located on the slope at left, descending into the plains of Wadi el-Far‘ah River. The range ascending to the left is Jebel Kebir. 1983.

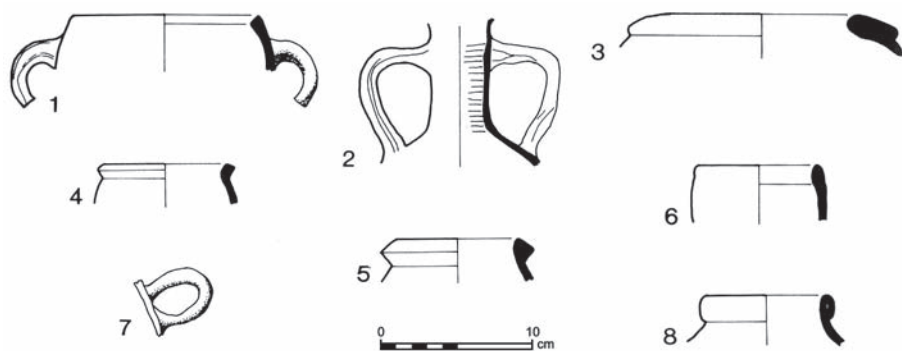
an especially sturdy masonry. In the center of the wadi there is a well-built dividing wall, possibly a dam. At the top of the site there is a built cistern. East of the ravine, on the cliffs, several looted burial caves are discerned, well hewn and with arched openings and niches inside. A looted, broken stone *sarcophagus* was also discovered.

The original construction of the site may have been during Iron Age II, and during the Early Roman Period it may have been used solely as a burial ground; but this requires additional investigation.

Pottery: IrA II – 30%; ER – 70%.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: SWP II, 241.



353. Pottery from Kh. Umm Qasim: nos. 1, 3 – IrA II; the rest – ER: 1. Jar, br; 2. Jug, lt br; 3. HM jar, gray/orange; 4-8. Jugs and jars, lt br.



Site 165: 18 – 18/43/2

Khallet esh-Shukreh

Israel grid: 1847 1836

UTM grid: 7239 5703

Elevation: 55 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 3.1 dunams (0.78 acre)

Topography: slope and ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Farr, no. 109), 1.2 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 6

Feb. 10, 1983; 49 shards

A site on a long, narrow ridge that descends northward to Wadi el-Far'ah from Jebel Kebir. This ridge ends, in its bottom part, at the enclosure of el-'Unuq (site no. 160 here).

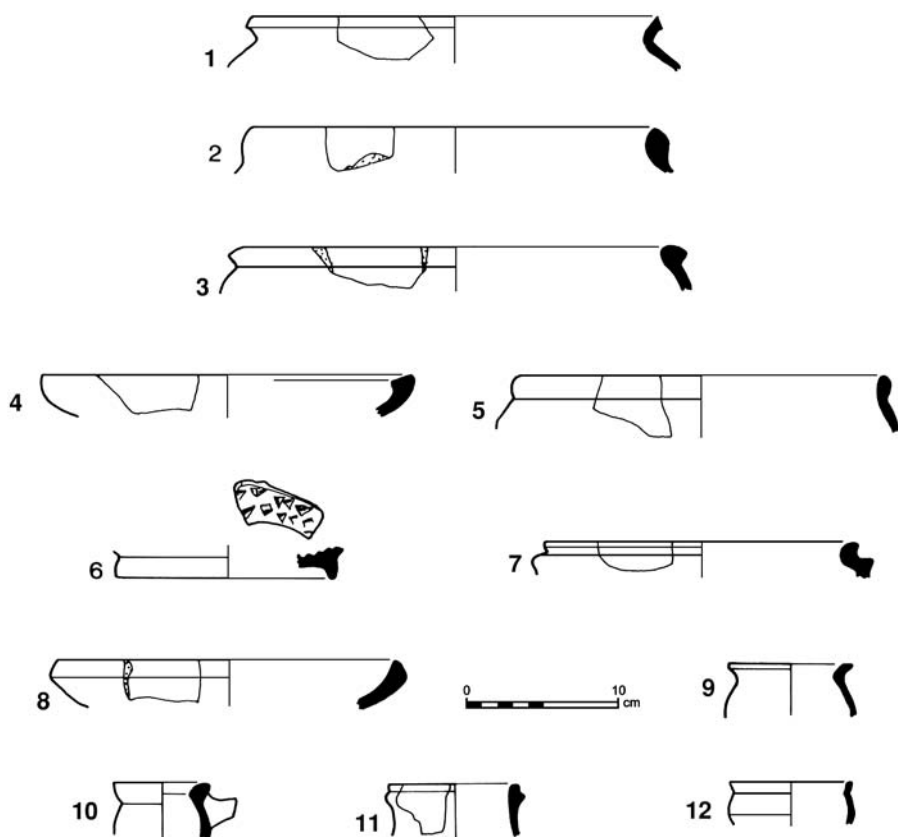
At the site are four steps, built on terraces. On these steps, there are a few structural remains and many shards. A road, built of two rows of

large curbstones and the 2 m wide, passes through the center of the site and descends toward el-'Unuq (site 160). There may be a connection between this site and el-'Unuq.

Pottery: IrA IA – 10%; IrA II – 60%; IrA III – 30%.

Special find: Bowl fragment with wedge decoration.

Previous surveys: none.



354. Pottery from Khallet esh-Shukreh: nos. 1-5 – IrA IA; 7-12 – IrA II; 6 – IrA III: 1. CP, Type A, dk br; 2-4. Bowls, br; 5. Crater, lt br; 6. Wedge-decorated bowl base, orange and black; 7. CP, br; 8. Bowl, br; 9-12. Jugs and jars, br.

Site 166: 18 – 18/43/1

Khirbet Bet Farr (A) (on SWP map: Kh. Beit Far)

Israel grid: 1848 1831

UTM grid: 7225 5698

Elevation: 150 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: tell

Area: 6.5 dunams (1.63 acres)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Farr, no. 109), 0.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 6

Dec. 6, 1983; 77 shards

* * *

A tell on an artificial step on a slope, upon one of the ridges descending from Jebel Kebir to Wadi el-Far'ah. To its east is Kh. Bet Farr (B) (site

no. 168 here), separated by a narrow ravine.

The tell rises about 9 m above the area to its north. In its center there



355. The Iron Age tell of Kh. Bet Farr (A), looking west. In the foreground are remains of the Kh. Bet Farr (B) site. At left is Jebel Kebir with Wadi el-Far'ah valley (right). Winter 1983.

is an enclosure or large courtyard, surrounded by a stone wall. Inside are structural remains, building stones and many shards. Beside this is another large structure, 20x20 m in size, whose walls are single stone wide.

The SWP surveyors mention just the later Bet Farr to the east (site no. 168 here). Porath, as well, did not differentiate between the two sites. Kappus divided the entire area into sections and dated them to the

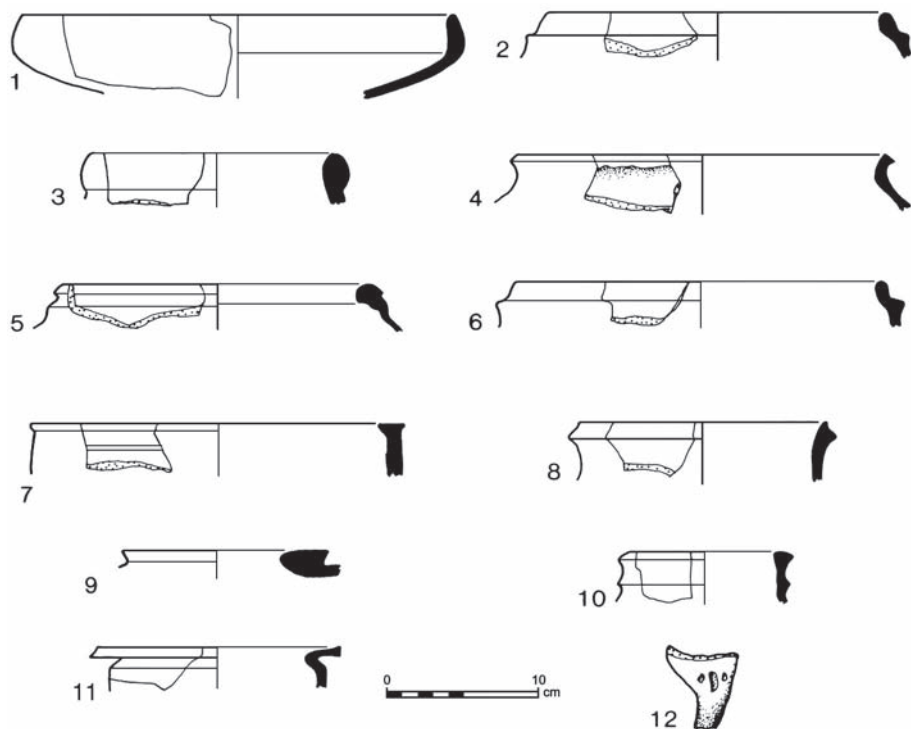
“Middle and Late Arab” periods.

Pottery: IrA IA – 20%; IrA II – 70%; IrA III – 10%; LR – 5%; Byz – 5%.

Special find: Handle with 'human face' decoration (IrA IA); see introduction on ceramics.

Identification: Porath's identification of this site as *Tiphseh* (II Kings 15:16) is difficult; see chapter on identifications.

Previous surveys: Kappus 1966, 79-80; Porath 1968, no. 72.



356. Pottery from Kh. Bet Farr (A): nos. 1-4, 12 – IrA IA; 8, 11 – LR; the rest – IrA II-III: 1. Bowl, lt br; 2. CP, br; 3. Pythos, br; 4. CP, dk br; 5. Crater, br; 6. CP, dk br; 7. Crater, lt br; 8. Jar, lt br; 9. HM jar, lt br; 10. Ridged jar, br; 11. Bowl, yel; 12. Dec handle, lt br.

Site 167: 18 – 18/73/1

el-Khirbeh (en-Nuseriyyeh)

Israel grid: 1874 1838

UTM grid: 7255 5705

Elevation: 15 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: historical site but does not appear on map

Site type: medium-sized ruin

Area: 9.8 dunams (2.45 acres)

Topography: slope and valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa, alluvium and

Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

June 27, 1982; 39 shards

* * *

A ruin on the northwestern part of Wadi el-Far'ah Valley, near the southern edge of Jebel Tammun; about 2 km to its southeast is Kh. Bet Hasan (site no. 173 here).

The ruin extends over the two

sides of a gorge (Wadi Nuseriyyeh). On the site are the remains of 20 houses, each with several rooms around a courtyard. The masonry is of large, local field stones, with walls 1 m wide. Other walls in the



357. el-Khirbeh (en-Nuseriyyeh), viewed from afar. The site is behind Kh. Bet Hasan (the settlement in the center of the valley). Above it is Jebel Tammun. 1992.

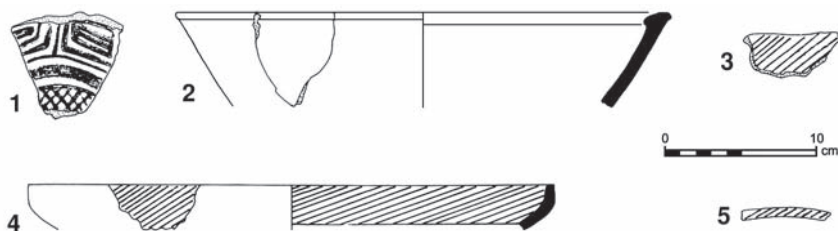
area are possibly agricultural terraces.

The place apparently relates to the main road nearby, as evidenced by other Medieval sites. The an-

cient name, Nuseriyyeh, has been preserved in the refugee settlement nearby.

Pottery: Per – 2%; MA – 98%.

Previous surveys: none.



358. Pottery from el-Khirbeh (en-Nuseriyyeh), all from MA except for no. 2 (EM): 1. Dec shard, br on wh; 2. Bowl, yel; 3. Plastic dec, yel; 4-5. Glazed bowls, green and yellow.



Site 168: 18 – 18/42/1

Khirbet Bet Farr (B) (on SWP map: Kh. Beit Far)

Israel grid: 1849 1829

UTM grid: 7228 5696

Elevation: 150 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 15.2 dunams (3.8 acres)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 19

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Farr, no. 109), 0.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Jiftliq (B3), 3 km distant

Visibility: 6

Feb. 10, 1983; 189 shards

A large site on the southern slope of Wadi el-Far‘ah Valley, on the second step descending from Jebel Kebir.

Parts of the site are surrounded by a built, stone wall. Inside are about 30 structures *in situ* and well planned streets. The structures are

of medium-sized field stones, some hewn, with doorposts *in situ*. Some structures extend outside and west of the enclosure wall, touching the eastern part of Kh. Bet Farr (A) (site no. 166 here). To the northeast is a large house, dated to the Ottoman Period, and a small spring. The area

is full with Bedouin dwellings.

Pottery: ER – 10%; LR – 10%; Byz – 10%; EM – 10%; MA – 60%.

Coin find: 16 coins from the Roman to Mameluk Periods; see appendix.

Identification: The existing proposal to identify it with *Bethpho-*

rum from the Crusader Period is possible. See chapter on identifications.

Previous surveys: Kappus 1966, 79-80; Porath 1968, 72.

Bibliography: SWP II, 237; Beyer 1940, 173 ff, 178 (regarding identification).



359. Aerial photo taken northward of Kh. Bet Farr (B). Above to the right is the Ottoman Period structure; next to it in the gorge is the spring, 'Ain Farr. Winter 1993.

Site 169: 18 – 18/52/1

Khirbet ‘Ain Farr

Israel grid: 1855 1829

UTM grid: 7238 5699

Elevation: 90 m a.s.l., 70 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical but does not appear on map

Site type: large site

Area: 18 dunams (4.5 acres)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Farr, no. 109), near the site

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1.2 km distant

Visibility: 3

Feb. 6, 1983; Dec. 28, 1984; 98 shards and 35 flint items

* * *

A large site on a low, broad ridge south of the Wadi el-Far‘ah valley. Northeast of the site is a spring, ‘Ain Farr, with a road (Aqrabaniyeh to Bet Farr) to the west. East of it

is a small, deep ravine, and to its south there is a low cliff.

The site extends along the axis of the ridge, in a northeast – southwest direction. On the ridge are a



360. View to the south of Kh. ‘Ain Farr and its environs. On the range is the Ottoman Period house; the gorge and spring are at its foot. In the foreground is the ridge of the site. Winter 1984.

number of low terraces with considerable shard scatter. On the top of the ridge there is a low acropolis, 3 dunams (0.75 acre) in size; no structural remains were found there.

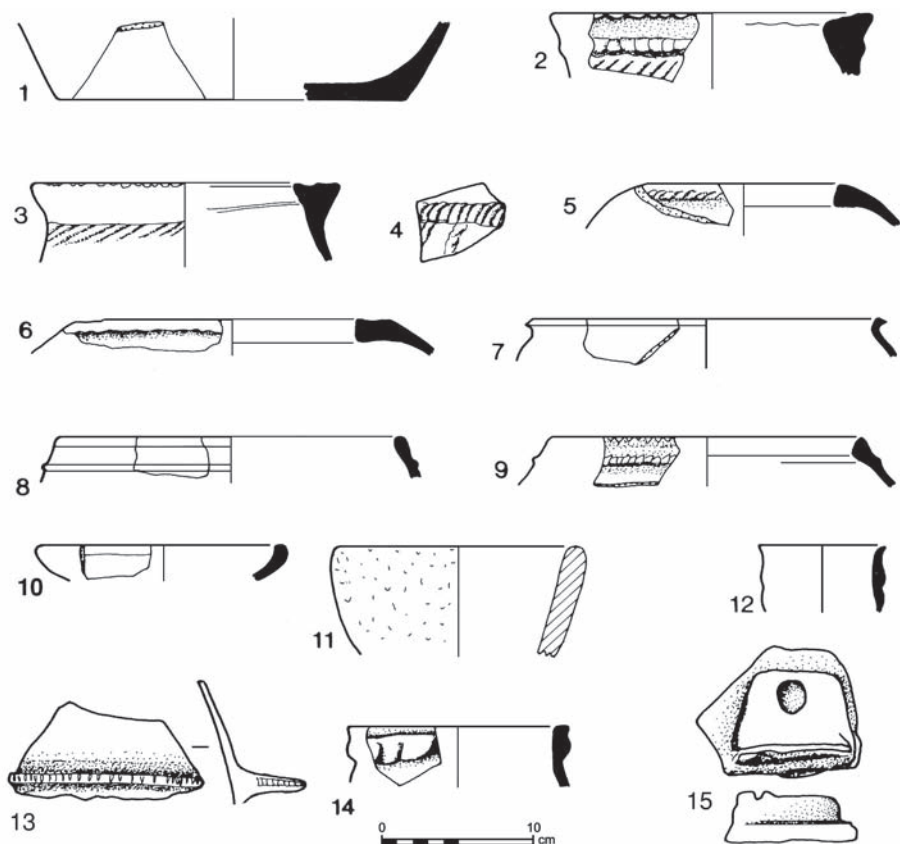
Pottery: Chal – 50%; EBA I – 30%; IrA IA – 20%.

Flint find: Chal and EBA; see appendix.

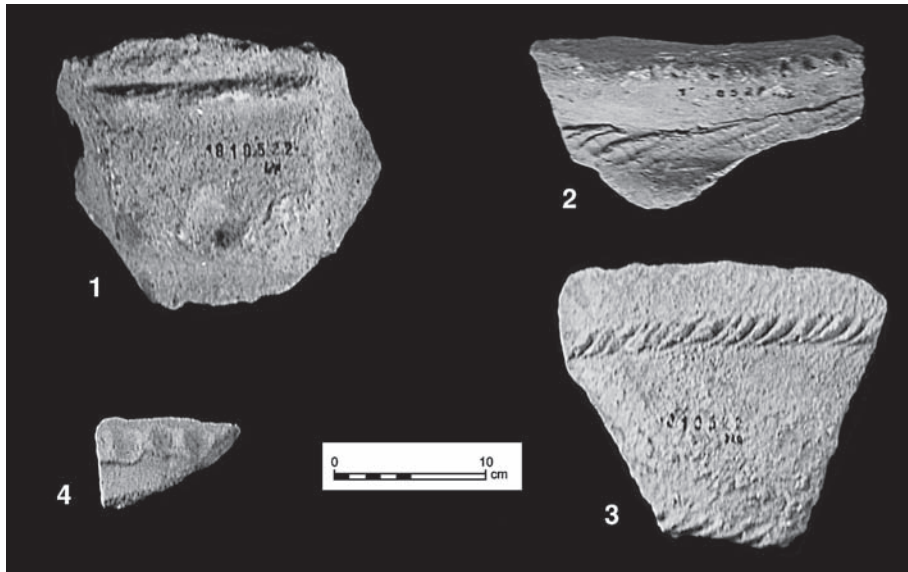
Ceramic notes: Many shards, from the end of the Chalcolithic Period ('Far'ah family'), are of thick ware with red slip and rope decoration; see discussion on ceramics.

Special find: Decoration on a large vessel, perhaps part of a temple model (?).

Previous surveys: none.



361. Pottery from Kh. 'Ain Farr, all from 'Far'ah family' (Chal – EBA I), except for nos. 7-10 (IrA IA) and no. 12 (Roman): 1. Jar base, yel; 2-3. Basins, lt br; 4. Rope dec; 5-6. HM jars, lt br; 7-9. CP, dk br; 10. Bowl, br; 11. Bowl, basalt; 12. Jar, lt br; 13-15. Handle, basin and 'temple' vessel, br.



362. Shard photos from Kh. 'Ain Farr.



Site 170: 18 – 18/52/2

ej-Jwar

Israel grid: 1852 1823
 UTM grid: 7215 5690
 Elevation: 182 m a.s.l., l.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: small ruin
 Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)
 Topography: plateau
 Rock type: 'Avdat formation
 Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 7
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Farr, no. 109), 0.8 km distant
 Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 3 km distant
 Visibility: 6
 Dec. 17, 1983; 30 shards

A small site in the middle step between Wadi el-Far'ah and Jebel Kebir. A modern house is located 0.2 km northwest of the site.

On the site are concentrations of shards, quarried and two cisterns. A road built of two rows of stones,

apparently of the Byzantine period, leads to the site. This section belongs to the road from Kh. Bet Farr to Tel el-Fukhar.

Pottery: LR – 50%; Byz – 50%.

Previous surveys: none.

Site 171: 18 – 18/72/1

Tel Miski (called in the SWP map and by Guérin Tell el-Kadhieh. Glueck names it Tell Umm es-Smaikh)

Israel grid: 1873 1824

UTM grid: 7252 5693

Elevation: 30 m b.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: fortified tell

Area: 15.5 dunams (3.88 acres)

Topography: hilltop and valley

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;
quality: 9

Cultivation: orchard (partial)

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Miski, no. 101), next to site

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 2

Feb. 6, 1983; June 6, 1986; 115 shards

* * *

A tell in the center of the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah and near the river gorge with a spring, 'Ain Miski, at its foot. The tell is elliptical in shape: its wide point is in the west, to become thinner in the east. Its southern part is planted now, with

houses nearby.

In the southeast corner of the tell a wall built of large, unhewn stones has been exposed; it is 2 m high (1983), probably to be dated to Iron Age II. A water-channel in the north has cut a large cross-section

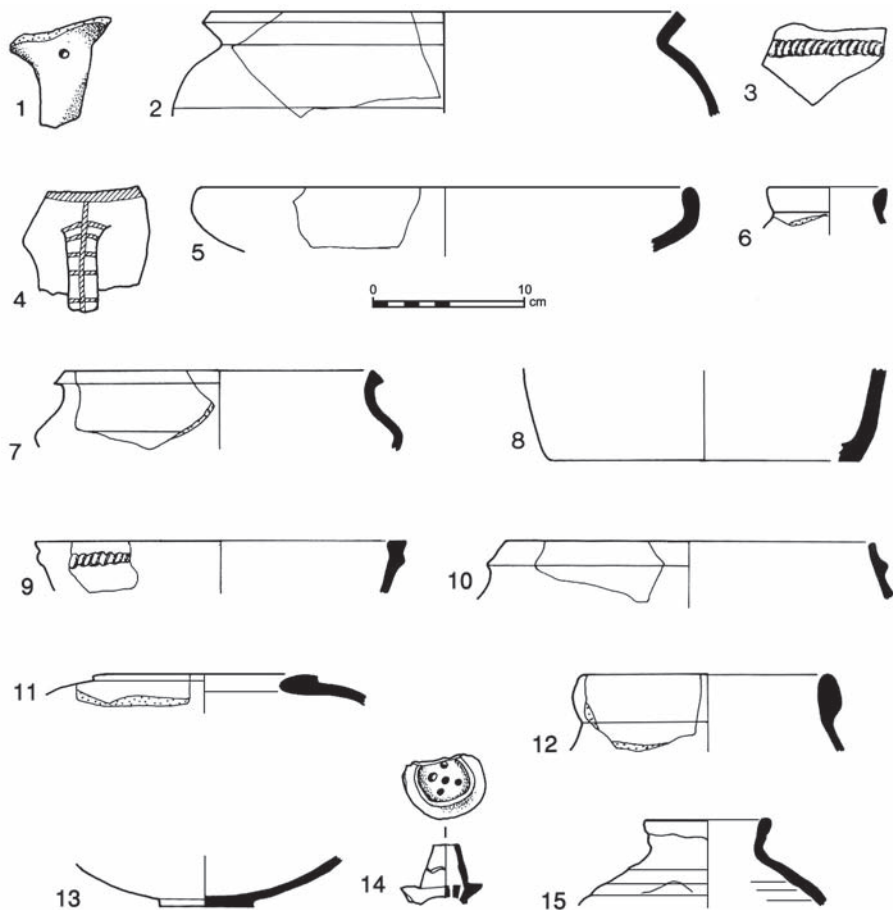


363. Tel Miski, seen from the west. The cut in the left was made by Wadi el-Far'ah.

in the tell, where at least six settlement layers are discernible; these include floors, walls and a brick wall (apparently from Early Bronze Age II). Several ceramic vessels protrude from the cross-section. On top of the tell are an Arab cemetery, remains of walls and a large depression, possibly a pool.

This is an important, fortified site from Iron Age I-II and before on the Wadi el-Far'ah valley. Glueck mentioned finding a "low, extensive tell" and wrote on the early shards there (Late Chalcolithic Period and Early Bronze Age I).

Pottery: Chal – 10%; EBA I-II – 20%; LB II – 10%; IrA I – 20%;



364. Pottery from Tel Miski: nos. 3, 9 – 'Far'ah family'; 8 – EBA I; 2, 4, 7, 13 – LB II; 1, 5, 10, 12 – IrA I; 11 – IrA II; 6, 15 – Hel; 14 – Byz: 1. Handle with indentation, br; 2, 7, 10. CP, dk br; 3, 9. Bowls with rope dec, lt br; 4. Jar handle, red dec on wh; 5. Bowl, lt br; 6. Jar, yel; 8. Jar base, yel; 11. HM jar, br; 12. Pythos, dk br; 13. Bowl base, yel; 14. Spout with filter, br; 15. Jar, pinkish.

IrA II – 25%; Per – 5%; LR – 5%;
Byz – 5%.

Flint find: Three items from an un-
defined period.

Coin find: Five coins from the Has-
monean to Byzantine Periods; see

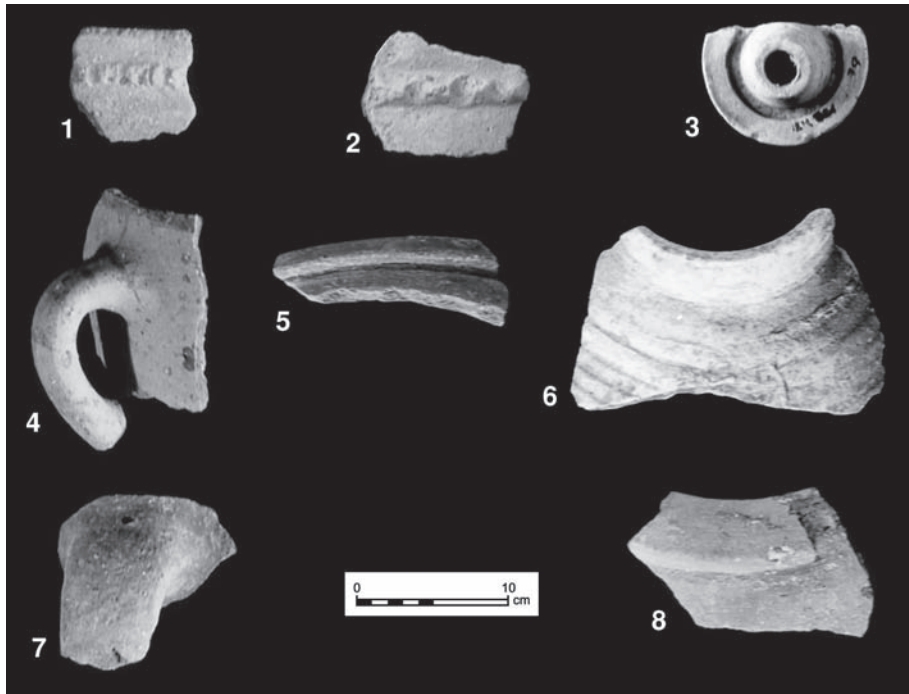
appendix.

Previous surveys: Glueck 1960,
320; Kappus 1966, 81-82; Porath
1968, no. 76; Kallai 1972, no. 3.

Bibliography: SWP II, 246; Guérin
1969 (IV), 262.



365. A view from the north of the wall (from the Iron Age?) of Tel Miski, exposed by the river. Standing: N. Mirkam. Winter 1983.



366. Pottery from Tel Miski: 1-2. Rope dec, Chal – EBA I; 3. Spout, Byz; 4. Jar handle, IrA II; 5. CP, IrA II; 6. Jar, Hel; 7. Jar handle with indentation, IrA I; 8. HM jar rim, IrA II.



Site 172: 18 – 18/72/2

Khirbet Murassas

Israel grid: 1873 1821

UTM grid: 7261 5688

Elevation: s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: small ruin

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: slope and valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;
quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.8 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1.5
km distant

Visibility: 4

Feb. 6, 1983; Dec. 28, 1984; 37
shards

A site on a cultivated hill, on a low
step south of Wadi el-Far'ah and

about 0.4 km south of Tel Miski.

Building stones and walls *in situ*,

that makes structural remains, were found in a plowed field, with shards nearby. In the field around them Early Bronze Age I shards were collected.

In Kh. Murassas marked on the

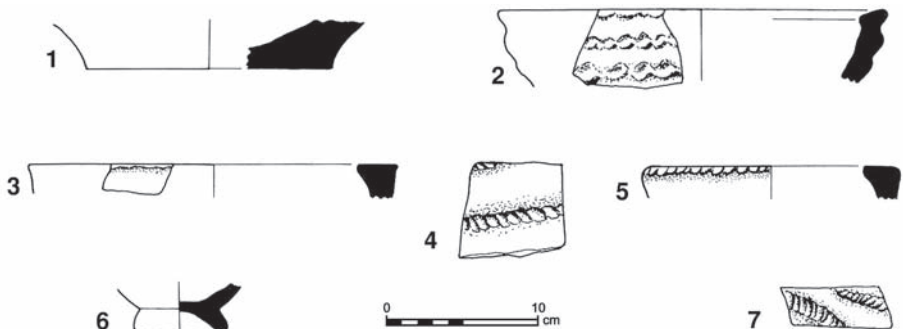
map there are new houses (from the time of Jordanian rule) without ancient shards.

Pottery: Chal – EBA I ('Far'ah family') – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



367. Kh. Murassas, looking southeast. The ancient site is on the ridge left of the houses. Jebel Kebir is in the background. Winter 1984.



368. Pottery from Kh. Murassas, all from 'Far'ah family' (Chal – EBA I), lt br: 1-3, 5. Basins, rope dec; 4, 7. Rope dec; 6. Amphoriskos (?) base.

Site 173: 18 – 18/82/1

Khirbet Bet-Hasan

Israel grid: 1883 1826

UTM grid: 7266 5694

Elevation: 40 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: on map but not as historical site

Site type: small ruin and Arab village

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)

Topography: ridge edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa, alluvium and

Mediterranean brown forest soil;
quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.3 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3),
passes by site

Visibility: 4

May 19, 1982; 29 shards

* * *

A site, with a refugee village on top of it, in the northwestern part of the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah, about 0.5 km north of the river and adjacent to the asphalt road to the Jor-

dan Valley.

The small village was founded after 1948. It was built on top of a ruin, whose remains were rendered indistinct and not it is impossible



369. Kh. Bet Hasan, seen from the northwest. Behind the site is the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah and Jebel Kebir. Spring 1982.

to characterize them. There are only shards there, without architecture.

Pottery: EBA I – 35%; EBA II – 20%; IrA II – 45%.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 79; Knierim 1969, 53.



Site 174: 18 – 18/92/1

Tel el-Hadad

Israel grid: 1896 1822

UTM grid: 7278 5691

Elevation: 36 m b.s.l., 17 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical place but does not appear on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 20 dunams (5 acres)

Topography: ridge edge and hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa, alluvium and

Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 0.6 km distant

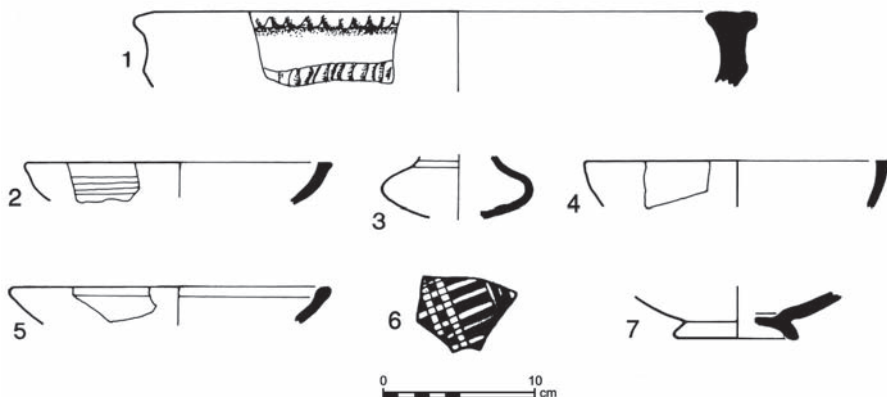
Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), passes by site

Visibility: 5

May 19, 1982; 44 shards

A large site on a hill, in the center of the valley and north of Wadi el-Far'ah. South of it pass the road to the Jordan Valley, with Tel Shibli (site no. 180 here) to its east.

On the summit and slopes (south, west and east) of the hill many shards and glass fragments are scattered. A few walls, with many scattered building stones, were found



370. Pottery from Tel el-Hadad: 1-2. Bowls, gray, EM; 3. Jars, MA; 4-5. Bowls, lt br, Byz; 6. Wh dec on bl, Byz – EM; 7. Bowl base, MA.

in situ, while the others were uprooted by the cultivation. On the southern slope of the tell is a large, round stone (1.3 m in diameter and 0.7 m thick) with a square hole in it, possibly a grindstone of an agricultural installation. The place is under heavy illegal excavations and

looting.

Pottery: LR – 15%; Byz – 50%; EM – 35%.

Coin find: Three coins from the Roman and Byzantine Periods; see appendix.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 80; Knierim 1969, no. 30.



371. Tel el-Hadad, viewed from the east, on the hill in the center of the photo. At left is the road to Shechem. 1988.

Site 175: 19 – 18/02/1

Wadi el-'Aris

Israel grid: 1900 1826

UTM grid: 7282 5695

Elevation: 45 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: ancient cemetery

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa, alluvium and Mediterranean brown forest soil;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 6

May 19, 1982; 107 shards

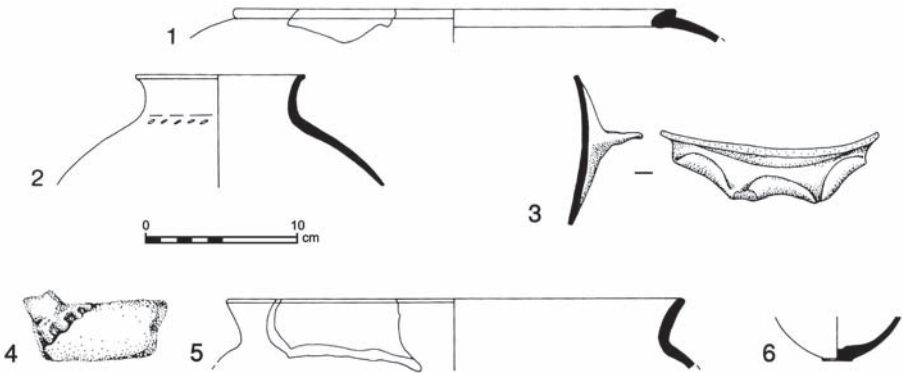
A large looted cemetery, the burial place of adjacent Tel Shibli or a regional graveyard.

By the time of our visit in 1982, about 30 graves had been broken into; these were shaft tombs characteristic of Middle Bronze Age I, and included a shaft 2 m deep and burial chambers. A large shard scat-

ter was found outside the looted graves, and additional grave openings were visible. Judging by size, it may be that this served as a graveyard for the entire area during Middle Bronze Age I.

Pottery: MBA I – 95%; MBA IIB – 5%.

Previous surveys: none.



372. Pottery from the cemetery at Wadi el-'Aris, all from MBA I except no. 6: 1. HM jar, gray; 2. Jar, yel; 3. Ledge handle, yel; 4. Rope dec; 5. Jar, dk gray; 6. Small jug, MBA II, yel.

Site 176: 18 – 18/51/1

Khirbet Tel el-Fukhar (on SWP map: Kh. Tel el Fokhar)

Israel grid: 1853 1814
 UTM grid: 7245 5682
 Elevation: 423 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.
 Name type: historical site on map
 Site type: tell and large ruin
 Area: 50 dunams (11 acres)
 Topography: slope
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 6
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: 18
 Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Jwar, no. 107), 0.75 km distant
 Nearest road: Far‘ah – Jiftliq (B3), 3 km distant
 Visibility: 8
 Jan. 8, 1984; 78 shards

* * *

A large site, including a tell and a ruin, above the middle, cliff-like step of Jebel Kebir. This step descending northward to the valley of Wadi el-Far‘ah. To its south is a small, inner valley. From the site is a fine view of Wadi el-Far‘ah and its environs.

On the western part of the complex is a small tell, 4 dunams (1 acre) in size. The tell was apparently fortified by a wall. From its top, with structures and installations on it, steep slopes descend to the north, east and west. To the south are ruined Arab houses, several decades old.

East of the tell, on an area of 15-20 dunams (4-5 acres), a large ruin

spreads over a saddle and a range. Remnants of walls, many burial caves, hewn installations (including wine-presses basins *in situ*) and other quarrying have been preserved. A considerable shard scatter is all over.

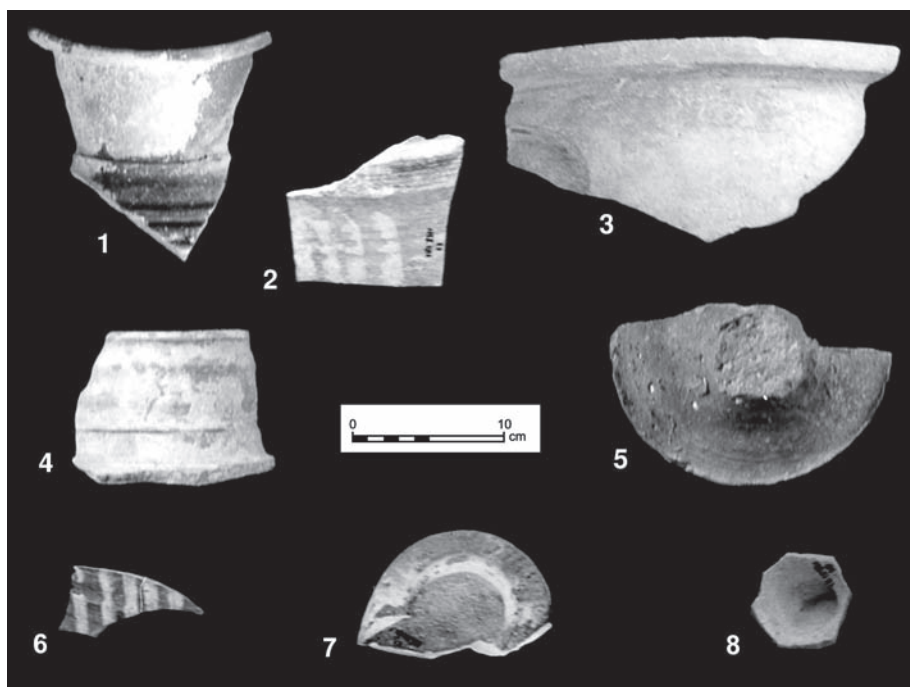
West of the ruin the complex the Jwar Valley is located, with built dams on a ravine descending from Jebel Kebir; their dating is unclear.

Pottery: Hel – 10%; ER – 20%; LR – 10%; Byz – 50%; EM – 10%.

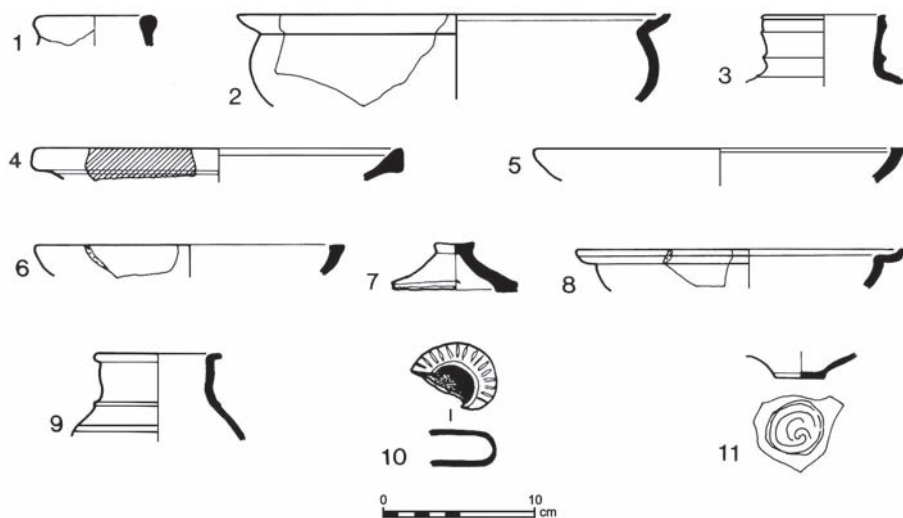
Coin find: 16 coins from Roman to Early Moslem Periods; see appendix.

Previous surveys: Kallai 1972, no. 11.

Bibliography: SWP II, 241.



373. Photos of pottery from Kh. Tel el-Fukhar: 1. Jar, LR; 2. Wh dec on bl, EM; 3. Bowl, EM; 4. Jar, ER; 5. Lid, Byz; 6. Shard with wh dec, EM; 7. Lamp, br, LR (see Fig. 374: 10); 8. Bowl base H, Hel. (see Fig. 374: 11).



374. Pottery from Kh. Tel el-Fukhar: 1. Jar, gray, Per-Hel; 2. Bowl, lt br, ER; 3. Jar, pk, ER; 4. Bowl, red slip, ER; 5. Bowl, bl, Byz; 6. Bowl, gray, Per-Hel; 7. Lid, bl/br, Byz; 8. Bowl, br, LR; 9. Jar, dk gray, Byz; 10. Lamp, br, LR; 11. Bowl base, lt, Hel;

Site 177: 18 – 18/91/2

ed-Dweir

Israel grid: 1891 1816

UTM grid: 7374 5685

Elevation: 40 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 1.2 dunams (0.3 acre)

Topography: ridge edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;
quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.3 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.7
km distant

Visibility: 3

Jan. 5, 1985; 78 shards and 23 flint
items

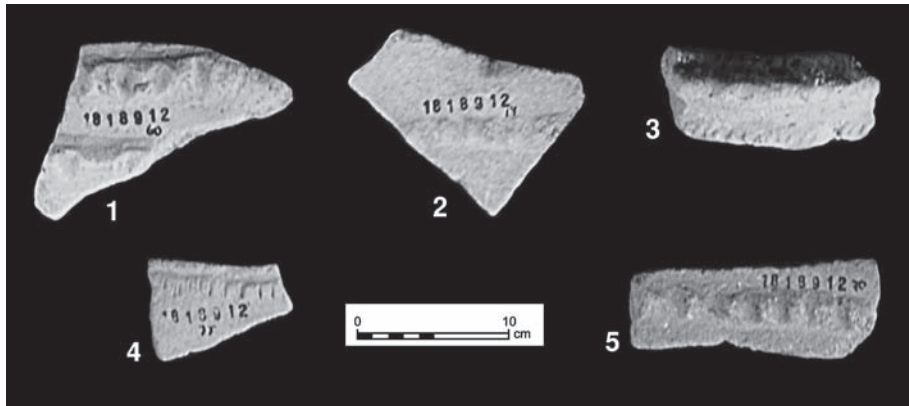
A small site on a slope descending into Wadi el-Far'ah, about 1 km south of Kh. Bet Hasan. There is a view of the irrigated river valley.

The foundations of eight to ten structures, built of medium-sized, unhewn field stones with right angles corners were found. The struc-

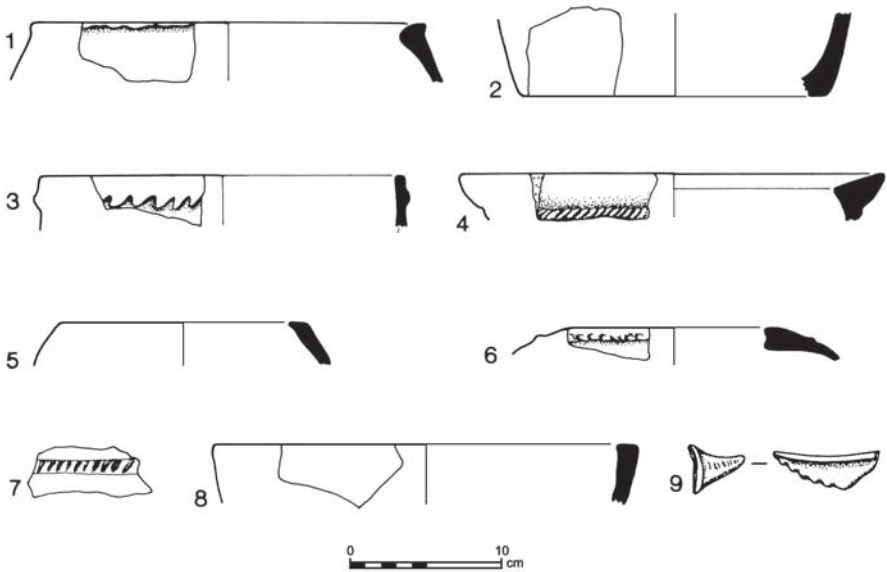
tures stand on an artificial rampart, about 30 cm higher than the surface of the slope. Many building stones have been preserved.

Pottery: Pottery Neolithic – 10%; Chal ('Far'ah family') – 40%; EBA – 50%.

Previous surveys: none.



375. Photos of shards from the site at ed-Dweir, all from the 'Far'ah family'.



376. Pottery from ed-Dweir, from 'Far'ah family' (Chal-EBA): 1. HM jar, lt br; 2. Base, gray; 3-4. Craters, lt br; 5-6. HM jars, br; 7. Rope dec; 8. Bowl, lt br; 9. Ridged ledge handle.



Site 178: 18 – 18/91/1

Jelamet el-Ahmar (A)

Israel grid: 1898 1814

UTM grid: 7281 5681

Elevation: 30 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin and ancient cemetery

Area: 50 dunams (12.5 acres)

Topography: ridge edge and hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: terra rossa, alluvium and Mediterranean brown forest soil;

quality: 5

Cultivation: uncultivated and field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 0.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

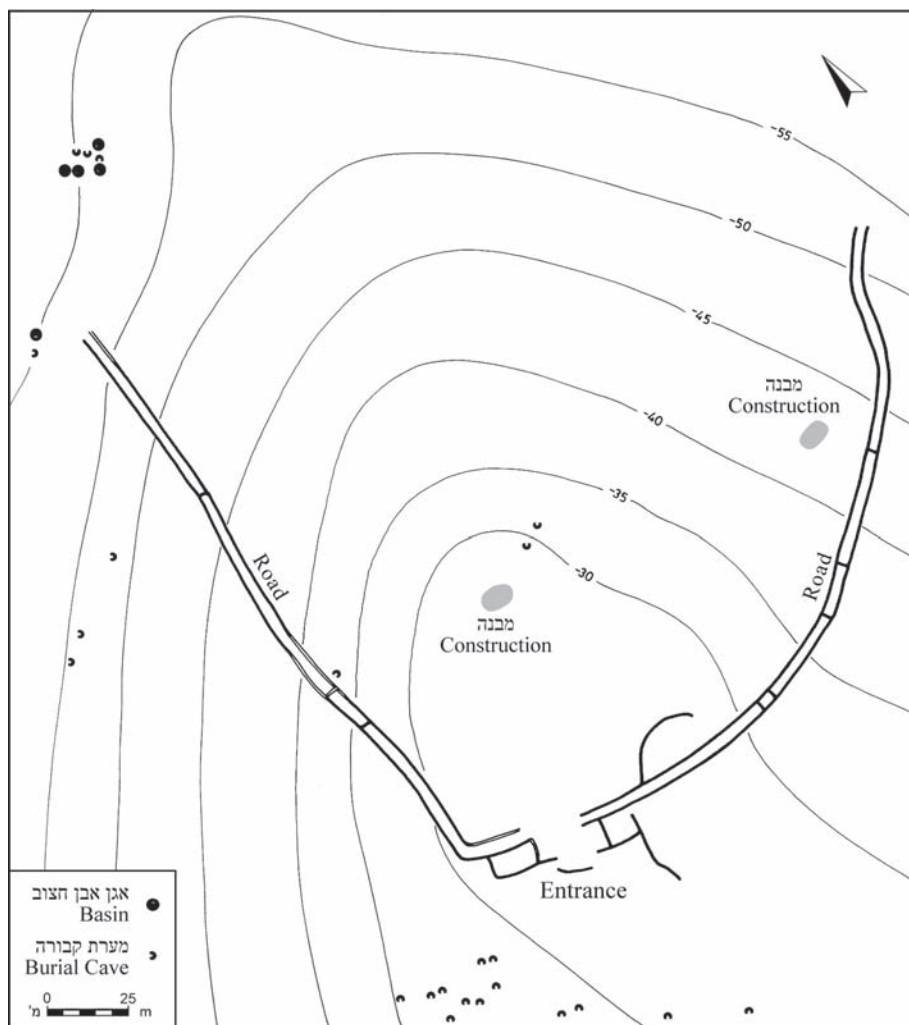
May 19, 1982; Jan. 10, 1992; 70 shards and 110 flint items

A site and a large cemetery on a wide, rocky hill south of Wadi el-Far'ah, in the middle of the river valley. The site is located opposite

to the pass of Bab en-Naqb and Tel Shibli, both north of the wadi; there is a sharp bend in the wadi at the foot of the site.

About two thirds of the hilltop are surrounded by a built 'road', which encircles the site on the east, south and west, with no remains on the northern side, where the cliff 'falls' to the deep wadi. This 'road' is built of two parallel rows of very large stones 4 m apart; some of the stones are in upright position. The

overall length of this 'road' is 480 m, with connecting walls ('stations') in eight places along the whole length. On the top of the hill, opposite E.P. -30, a large, double structure was found, which contains two rectangular structures, each about 10x15 m in size, with an opening between them. This arrangement,



377. The plan of the site at Jelamet el-Ahmar (A). Note the "procession road", the entrance structure and the grave openings.

located in the center and 'tip' of the 'road', may have been used as an entrance to the complex. Over the entire area, dozens of burial caves, looted in the process of being looted, are discerned. The tombs contained hewn shafts and openings, with grave niches and burial halls. Shards and parts of vessels are scattered all over the looted areas. On the hill and the slopes hewn basins were also found, with an average diameter of 30-50 and depth of 40 cm.

The site is an especially large

burial complex which apparently contained hundreds of burial caves. The built road ('procession road') was probably used for burial ceremonies, mainly during the Early Bronze Age. Wadi el-Far'ah and its valley, both sides of the wadi, were used during many periods as a central burial area.

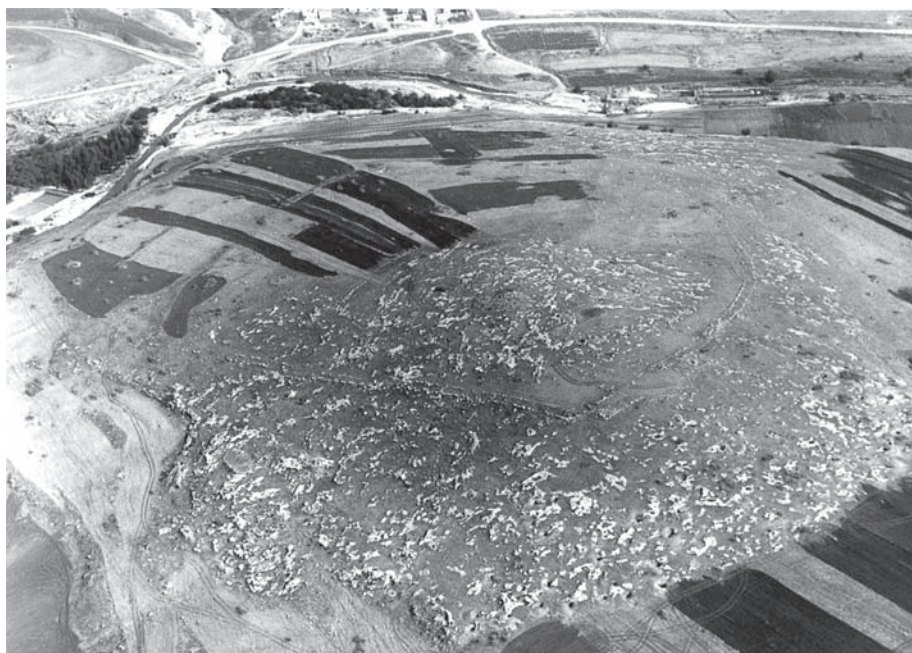
Pottery: Neolithic – 5%; EBA I – 45%; EBA II – 50%.

Flint find: 110 items from Pottery Neolithic and EBA; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



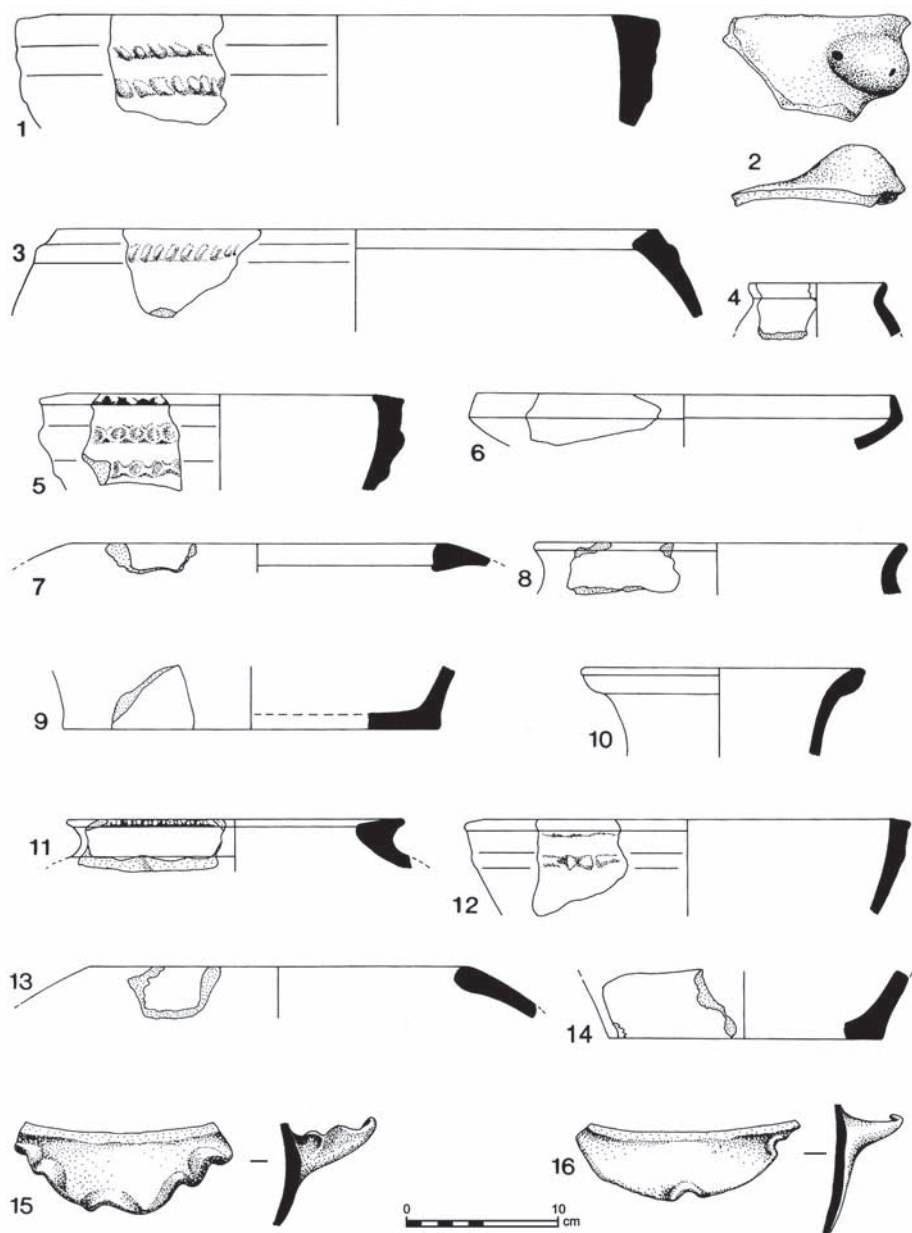
378. The hill of Jelamet el-Ahmar (A), looking southeast. The site is on the hill, beyond the low Wadi el-Far'ah and the electric poles. Spring 1982.



379. Aerial photo, looking northeast, of the site of Jelamet el-Ahmar (A). In the left is Wadi el-Far'ah and the road to the Jordan Valley. Winter 1992.



380. A view to the west of the "procession road", 1984



381. Shards from Jelamet el-Ahmar (A), nos. 1, 3, 5, 12 – 'Far'ah family'; 2 – Neol; the rest – EBA I-II: 1, 3, 5. Bowls, br, rope dec; 2. Dec; 4. Small jar, br; 6. Platter; 7, 13. HM jars, yel; 8, 10-11. Jars, br and yel; 9, 14. Jar bases, yel; 12. Bowl, br, rope dec; 15-16. Ledge handles.